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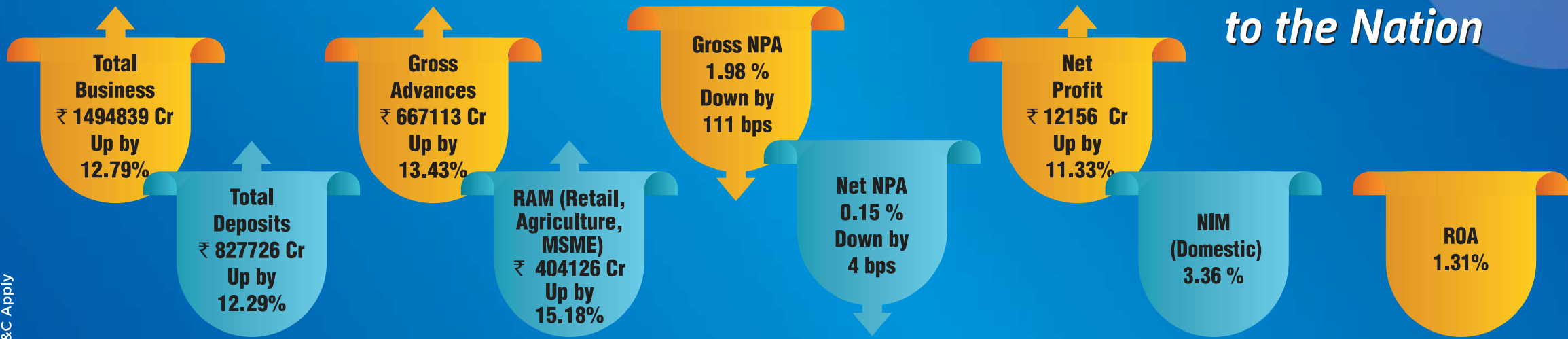
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Audited Financial Results (Standalone / Consolidated) for the Quarter / Year Ended March 31, 2026

(₹ in crore)

Sl. No.	Particulars	Standalone				Consolidated			
		Quarter Ended 31.03.2026 (Audited)	Quarter Ended 31.03.2025 (Audited)	Year Ended 31.03.2026 (Audited)	Year Ended 31.03.2025 (Audited)	Quarter Ended 31.03.2026 (Audited)	Quarter Ended 31.03.2025 (Audited)	Year Ended 31.03.2026 (Audited)	Year Ended 31.03.2025 (Audited)
1.	Total income from operations (Net)	19980.07	18599.16	77441.29	71225.64	20261.23	18794.36	78332.70	72050.88
2.	Net Profit / (Loss) for the period (before Tax, Exceptional and / or Extraordinary items)	4059.97	4224.07	16403.72	14786.93	4077.81	4229.81	16501.54	14887.38
3.	Net Profit / (Loss) for the period before Tax (after Exceptional and / or Extraordinary items)	4059.97	4224.07	16403.72	14786.93	4077.81	4229.81	15734.95	14887.38
4.	Net Profit / (Loss) for the period after Tax (after Exceptional and / or Extraordinary items)	3103.13	2956.07	12155.65	10918.29	3173.05	2981.64	11704.28	11261.47
5.	Total Comprehensive Income for the period [comprising profit/(loss) for the period (after tax) and other Comprehensive Income (after tax)]	Refer Note 2	Refer Note 2	Refer Note 2	Refer Note 2	Refer Note 2	Refer Note 2	Refer Note 2	Refer Note 2
6.	Paid-up Equity Share Capital	1346.96	1346.96	1346.96	1346.96	1346.96	1346.96	1346.96	1346.96
7.	Reserves (excluding Revaluation Reserve as shown in the Audited Balance Sheet of previous year)	69876.76	60762.20	69876.76	60762.20	71628.40	62965.17	71628.40	62965.17
8.	Securities Premium Account	6290.02	6290.02	6290.02	6290.02	6290.02	6290.02	6290.02	6290.02
9.	Net Worth	65627.59	57028.96	65627.59	57028.96				
10.	Paid-up Debt Capital/Outstanding Debt**	22421.14	25038.98	22421.14	25038.98				
11.	Debt Equity Ratio**	0.34	0.44	0.34	0.44				
12.	Earnings Per Share (of ₹ 10/- each) (for continuing and discontinued operations)								
	Basic :	*23.04	*21.95	90.24	81.06	*23.56	*22.14	86.89	83.61
	Diluted :	*23.04	*21.95	90.24	81.06	*23.56	*22.14	86.89	83.61
13.	Capital Redemption Reserve	NIL	NIL	NIL	NIL	NIL	NIL	NIL	NIL
14.	Debenture Redemption Reserve	NIL	NIL	NIL	NIL	NIL	NIL	NIL	NIL
15.	Debt Service Coverage Ratio	Not Applicable	Not Applicable	Not Applicable	Not Applicable	Not Applicable	Not Applicable	Not Applicable	Not Applicable
16.	Interest Service Coverage Ratio	Not Applicable	Not Applicable	Not Applicable	Not Applicable	Not Applicable	Not Applicable	Not Applicable	Not Applicable

* Not Annualised ** Debt represents borrowing with residual maturity of more than one year.

Note: 1.The above is an extract of the detailed format of Quarterly / Yearly Financial Results filed with the Stock Exchanges under Regulation 33 and Regulation 52 of the SEBI (Listing Obligations and Disclosure Requirements) Regulations, 2015. The full format of the Quarterly / Yearly Financial Results are available on the Stock Exchange(s) websites (www.nseindia.com and www.bseindia.com) and Bank's website (www.indianbank.bank.in).
2. Information relating to Total Comprehensive Income and other Comprehensive Income is not furnished as Ind AS is not yet made applicable to the Bank.
3. The Board of Directors has recommended a Dividend of ₹18.25 per equity share (182.50% of face value of ₹10 each) in its meeting held on 29.04.2026 subject to Shareholders' approval in Annual General Meeting.

QR CODE
for Result



Place : Chennai
Date : 29.04.2026

Mini T M
Executive Director

Brajesh Kumar Singh
Executive Director

Shiv Bajrang Singh
Executive Director

Ashutosh Choudhury
Executive Director

Binod Kumar
Managing Director & CEO

Corporate Office: 254-260, Avvai Shanmugam Salai, Royapettah, Chennai - 600 014.

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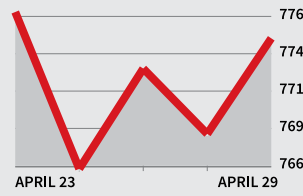
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IN FOCUS

	LATEST	CHANGE
Nifty 50	24177.65	+181.95
P/E Ratio (Sensex)	21.10	+0.03
US Dollar (in ₹)	94.85	+0.31
Gold Std 10 gm (in ₹)	147380.00	-806
Silver 1 kg (in ₹)	236300.00	-241

FUEL COST WOES

Air India Express expected to post a loss of around ₹3,500 crore in FY26 on pricey ATF, say sources **p9**



DOUBLE-EDGED WEAPON

Cybersecurity experts caution Mythos AI isn't a magic wand against all vulnerabilities **p12**

QUICKLY.

BUCKING CRISIS
FTAs to drive export growth, says Goyal



New Delhi: Commerce Minister Piyush Goyal has said India's goods exports in the first three weeks of April have increased despite the West Asia crisis, noting that the recent FTAs signed by India and an additional dozen being negotiated would give a big boost to the domestic industry. New Delhi is currently negotiating with key partners, signalling a push to expand its FTA network. **p3**

WEST ASIA WAR WOES
Rupee closes at record low amid rising oil prices

Mumbai: The rupee slipped to a record closing low against the US dollar on Wednesday amid rising oil prices, persistent FPI related dollar outflows and geopolitical uncertainty linked to the West Asia conflict. The Indian currency closed at 94.8450 per US dollar, down about 31 paise against the previous close of 94.54. **p5**

Centre pushes for 100% ethanol-powered vehicles

AMBITIOUS SHIFT. Industry flags 'mileage penalty' and feedstock gaps

Our Bureau
New Delhi

To push an ambitious shift towards 100 per cent ethanol blending, the government moved to align vehicle regulations to formally integrate E100 (100 per cent ethanol) into the country's regulatory architecture, effectively legalising the certification and mass production of flex-fuel vehicles (FFVs).

While the E20 (20 per cent ethanol) will continue as monofuel available across the country, the latest move encourages introduction of higher ethanol blends in vehicle manufacturing.

MOV RULES CHANGE

The Ministry of Road Transport and Highways issued a draft notification on April 27, seeking to amend the Central Motor Vehicles Rules, 1989 to formally allow vehicle standards covering fuels up to E100, replacing earlier references that were limited to E85.

The draft seeks to amend Rule 115, expanding emission-related tables and fuel



FUELLING CHANGE

India's petrol consumption reached 42.59 million tonnes. Ethanol now makes up 8.52 mt of total petrol volume

classifications to include high-blend ethanol and B100 biodiesel. Crucially, the notification increases the gross vehicle weight category for compliance from 3,000 kg to 3,500 kg.

The changes also expand petrol compatibility norms from E10 to E20 and introduce provisions for B100 biodiesel, indicating that the regulatory architecture is being widened to support a full range of high-blend fuels.

References related to hydrogen plus compressed natural gas nomenclature have been revised, while petrol fuel classifications have been updated to reflect "E10/E20" categories.

FUEL SALES MAY RISE

Petrol sales in India grew by approximately 6 per cent in 2025-26, reaching 42.59 million tonnes (mt). Following the successful nationwide rollout of the E20 mandate, ethanol now accounts for 8.52 mt of that volume.

However, industry experts warn that as blending levels rise toward E100, the overall growth rate of fuel sales may accelerate further.

This is largely due to the "mileage penalty" since high-ethanol blends possess lower energy density, consumers must purchase a higher volume of fuel to cover the same distance, potentially increasing the total market demand for blended petrol.

While India has built a robust distillation infrastructure, boasting a capacity of 2,000 crore litres as of March 2026, achieving E100 parity

remains a feedstock challenge. Industry leaders, including Atul Chaturvedi of Shree Renuka Sugars, noted that while current capacities can comfortably support a 30 per cent blend, moving beyond that threshold requires a significant scaling of raw materials.

Currently, feedstock efficiency varies wildly: a tonne of sugarcane juice yields only 70 litres of ethanol, whereas grain-based alternatives like broken rice and maize offer a more concentrated output of up to 475 litres per tonne.

The automobile industry, represented by the Society of Indian Automobile Manufacturers (SIAM), is approaching the transition with a blend of technical readiness and fiscal caution. The leap to E100 introduces a significant "efficiency gap".

"We are reviewing the draft internally," a SIAM official noted, emphasising that pricing and availability of ethanol, matching pace of the automobile industry to manufacture vehicles with new engines, pricing of vehicles, fuel efficiency have to align for full adaptation.

West Asia crisis creates a need to reprioritise policies, fiscal spending: CEA Nageswaran

Our Bureau
Chennai

The tensions in West Asia present significant macroeconomic risks in FY27 as the conflict emerges as a short-term challenge to India's long-term goals, Chief Economic Advisor V Anantha Nageswaran said on Wednesday.

Framing the choice as one between *Sreya* (delayed gratification) and *Preya* (instant gratification), he emphasised that India's growth strategy must focus on medium- to long-term investments even as macroeconomic risks rise in the near term.

STRUCTURAL IMPACT

With nearly 87 per cent dependence on imported crude and significant reliance on the Gulf region for remittances, the impact is both immediate and structural; rising crude prices and disrupted supply chains are already weighing on the economy, the CEA said.

He was speaking at an event organised by MCCIL.

India enters this challenging phase from a position of relative strength, having maintained over 7 per cent



Chief Economic Advisor V Anantha Nageswaran (right) in an interaction with *businessline* Editor Raghuvir Srinivasan. BUJOY GHOSH

growth, but the path ahead will require faster decision-making, sharper execution and a clear shift towards long-term capacity building.

The crisis could serve as a "silver lining" by forcing India to diversify sourcing, invest in resilience and accelerate reforms, including in agriculture.

Nageswaran stressed that India's growth ambitions hinge on accelerating its manufacturing transformation in a world where globalisation is fragmenting. "Cost efficiency alone can no longer drive manufacturing decisions. Resilience, diversification and strategic autonomy are equally important," he said.

However, execution at the State level — particularly in land, labour and logistics — remains critical for success, he

said. A major bottleneck to manufacturing expansion is the shortage of skilled labour. India cannot achieve its target of raising manufacturing to 25 per cent of GDP without strengthening trade skills such as electrical work, machining and construction.

UNCERTAINTY AHEAD

Later in a conversation with *businessline* Editor Raghuvir Srinivasan, Nageswaran pushed back against industry concerns over global uncertainty. "You have to live with uncertainty for the next two decades. It cannot be a reason to postpone investments," he said. "The challenge is no longer just about producing more, but about producing competitively, resiliently and at scale in a fragmented world," he said.

DEMOCRACY DRIVE



POLL JOURNEY. A group of villagers, holding their voter identity cards, travel on a motorised tricycle to a polling station in North 24 Parganas to cast their votes during the second phase of West Bengal Assembly elections on Wednesday. The Election Commission said the turnout for the 142 seats was the highest ever at 92.47 per cent. **(Report on p5)** ANI

In a first-ever, gold investments outshine jewellery demand in 2026 Q1; ETFs lead

Suresh P Iyengar
Mumbai



money whenever gold prices declined.

India's investment demand for gold overtook jewellery consumption for the first time ever in the March quarter of calendar 2026, as consumers deferred jewellery purchases due to the volatile prices and opted instead to invest in instruments such as gold exchange-traded funds.

According to the World Gold Council's demand trends for Q1, the investment demand surged 54 per cent year-on-year to 82 tonnes, surpassing jewellery demand, which declined 19 per cent to 66 tonnes. The fall in the stock markets and the unusual volatility in equities saw investors turning to gold instruments, pumping in more

This shift was driven by a sharp rise in domestic gold prices, which climbed 81 per cent y-o-y to record levels, denting affordability in the jewellery segment while boosting gold's appeal as a safe-haven investment.

Overall, gold demand in India was up 10 per cent to 151 tonnes in Q1 2026, while in value terms it nearly doubled to a record ₹2.27-lakh crore, reflecting the impact of elevated prices.

Investment demand was led by record inflows into gold ETFs, rising nearly six-fold to ₹30,000 crore in value and three times in volume to 20 tonnes, in addition to strong buying of bars and coins, which accounted for 62 tonnes, nearly matching jewellery volumes.

VALUE TERMS

In contrast, jewellery demand was down 19 per cent to 66 tonnes (82 tonnes) but increased 47 per cent to ₹99,920 crore (₹68,050 crore) in value terms as prices turned volatile and hit record highs in the March quarter.

The WGC estimated the full-year demand to be in the range of 650-750 tonnes against 768 tonnes registered in 2025, with investment demand to remain a key driver of

India's gold market in the near term, supported by macroeconomic uncertainty, volatile equity markets and continued global price strength.

Gold prices zoomed 81 per cent to ₹1.51 lakh per 10 gram against ₹83,375 logged last year. With high prices, recycled gold quantum increased 19 per cent at 31 tonnes (26 tonnes). Despite high prices, gold imports rose 39 per cent to 196 tonnes (141 tonnes) even as prices rallied 82 per cent to \$4,873 (\$2,680) an ounce.

Sachin Jain, Regional CEO, India, World Gold Council, said the domestic gold market in March quarter reflects a continued divergence between volume trend and value growth, shaped by record-high prices and evolving consumer preferences.

Sun Pharma puts in place team to integrate Organon global ops

PT Jyothi Datta
Mumbai



Kirti Ganorkar, MD, Sun Pharma, and CFO Jayashree Satagopan

Days after Sun Pharmaceutical Industries announced its \$11.75-billion deal to acquire Organon, the Indian drugmaker is putting in place a team to oversee the integration of the US-based healthcare company's global operations, once the approvals come in, said top representatives of Sun's management team.

The idea is to have a dedicated integration office, with representation from both sides, Sun Pharma Managing Director Kirti Ganorkar told *businessline*.

"We can start the planning process, but we can't take a decision till it (the transaction) is closed officially, which will take six-nine months," said Ganorkar, a veteran not just with Sun, but also at integration, having joined the company (1996) ahead of its buy of US-based Caraco Pharma (1997). Subsequently there have been many other buys, including the acquisition of troubled Ranbaxy and the long-drawn, cross-country purchase of Israeli/US company Taro Pharma.

UNIQUE ACQUISITION
"Every acquisition is unique in its nature," says Ganorkar,

adding that integration cannot be approached with the same template used for Taro, or Ranbaxy. "What is a common theme is the people and portfolio," he says.

The top managements of both Sun and Organon have held townhalls with their employees, after the announcement of the transaction earlier this week. The integration committee is expected to start in less than a month, said Sun Pharma Chief Financial Officer Jayashree Satagopan.

It would look at evaluating "portfolios, people, functions, commercial footprint, opportunities for licencing, everything," she added.

Both will remain independent companies, said Ganorkar, even as Sun eventually looks to delist Organon from the NYSE. Organon has about 10,000 people. The India operation is small, and complementary in nature, said Ganorkar.

Cognizant signals layoffs under Project Leap

Our Bureau
Chennai

With AI shaking up IT sector, Cognizant has launched 'Project Leap', a plan to move to an AI-led delivery that involves \$200-270 million in severance and other costs, indicating employee lay-offs are on the cards.

The company did not disclose the number of people set to be impacted, but estimates a net savings of

\$200-300 million from this initiative in 2026.

This comes at a time when the IT major added around 21,000 people y-o-y as of March 2026, and reiterated plans to hire over 20,000 freshers in 2026, perhaps an indication that the focus will be on the middle and top layer. Cognizant also reported strong deal momentum in Q1, and announced acquisition of Astreya, an AI-first managed services firm.

More reports p2

THE BENGAL MYSTERY
Exit polls were split in their prediction for West Bengal,

QUICKLY.

Adani Power Q4 profit jumps 52% to ₹4,017 crore



Ahmedabad: Adani Power Ltd reported a 52 per cent year-on-year rise in consolidated net profit to ₹4,017 crore in the fourth quarter of FY26, supported in part by lower tax expenses, even as operating revenue remained broadly flat amid subdued demand. Its revenue from operations stood at ₹14,223 crore in Q4 FY26, marginally lower by 0.09 per cent compared to the same period last year, reflecting subdued short-term demand conditions. On a full-year basis, revenue declined 3.5 per cent year-on-year to ₹54,240 crore, while net profit edged down 0.8 per cent to ₹12,834 crore. The strong bottom-line performance in the March quarter came despite muted topline growth, aided by stable plant operations, improved realisations in contracted capacities, and a lower effective tax burden.

OUR BUREAU

Cognizant Q1 2026 revenue up 4%; quarterly profit flat at \$662 m

OUTLOOK. IT major guides for constant currency growth of 3.2-4.7% for June quarter

Rohan Das
Chennai

IT major Cognizant on Wednesday reported revenues of \$5.4 billion for the March quarter, a 3.9 per cent year-on-year growth in constant currency terms on the back of double-digit growth in financial services vertical. The growth was within Cognizant's guidance range. The company has now guided a constant currency growth of 3.2 per cent to 4.7 per cent for the quarter ending June 2026. For the full year of 2026, the IT major kept guidance unchanged at 4-6.5 per cent in constant currency. At a press conference after the announcement of its results, Jatin Dalal, CFO, said that despite robust deal momentum, the company's full year guidance remains unchanged considering the current geopolitical environment. The net profit was flat at \$662 million (\$663 million). On a trailing 12-month basis, bookings increased 11



Q4 scorecard			
	March 2025	March 2026	Change
Revenue (in \$ million)	5,115	5,413	5.8%
Net profit (in \$ million)	663	662	-
Head count	3,36,300	3,57,600	21,300
Voluntary Attrition - Tech Services TTM (in %)	15.8	12.3	-

per cent year-over-year to \$29.6 billion including seven large deals (contract value of \$100 million or greater) and one mega deal (contract value \$500 million or greater). **ASTREYA DEAL** Cognizant announced that it has entered into a definitive agreement to acquire Astreya, a US-based IT managed services and solutions provider for data centre hyperscalers, for an undisclosed sum. "Astreya is an AI infrastructure build out com-

pany with data centre and network services. It's one of the pieces of the puzzle for the AI builder stack for us, and fits in complementary to all the infrastructure services we have been offering," Cognizant CEO Ravi Kumar S said. Cognizant beat its peers in the quarter in revenue growth (on a CC basis). Infosys posted a growth of 4.1 per cent, Wipro 0.2 per cent, and HCL Tech 2.4 per cent, while TCS clocked a de-growth of 0.6 per cent year-on-year in the quarter ended March 2026.

Cognizant reported a headcount of 3,57,600 as of March 31, 2025, an increase of 21,300 on a year-on-year basis and 6,000 on a sequential basis. Voluntary attrition (on a trailing 12-month basis) was 12.3 per cent, compared to 15.8 per cent in the year-ago quarter. The company has, however, modified its definition of attrition excluding certain categories of negotiated separations. "In a complex macroeconomic environment, we delivered first quarter revenue growth in the upper half of our guidance range, with sustained bookings momentum and financial services again leading performance. We signed seven large deals in the quarter and delivered over 70 per cent large deal total contract value growth year-over-year," said Kumar. While geographically, the company saw the highest growth in North America at 4.9 per cent on-year in CC terms, financial services bounced back to double digit growth at 10.2 per cent.

Cognizant launches Project Leap for AI-led future, signals layoffs and reshaping of pyramid model

Sindhu Hariharan
Rohan Das
Chennai

As AI disrupts the traditional IT services model, Cognizant on Wednesday announced Project Leap, a new programme for AI-led delivery in the future that not just involves investments in AI capabilities & partnerships and reskilling of workforce but will also see the company lay off workforce. Describing Project Leap as a transformation programme, Cognizant said it expects to incur costs of \$230-320 million in 2026 as part of the programme, with \$200-270 million in employee severance and other personnel related costs and \$30-50 million in other charges. Cognizant did not quantify the number of employees who may be impacted. However, CFO Jatin Dalal told mediapersons that

“Restructuring part of goal of a ‘broader and shorter’ pyramid with fewer layers of management and a wider base of AI-native junior employees”

RAVI KUMAR S
CEO, Cognizant

it involves “investment in form of severance that we'll have to pay and it's a global programme and various parts of the organisation will get impacted”. Industry analysts said that the impact could be in several thousands given the severance costs specified. Cognizant expects the initiative to lead to cost savings of \$200-300 million in 2026, which it says will be used to fund invest-



ments in AI capabilities and to upskill and reshape the productivity of its workforce. It also expects margins to expand by 20 to 40 basis points as a result of Project Leap. “This is a programme which is focused on the interdisciplinary skill sets that we need to succeed in the future, that we will have to invest in. It will have an investment in the form of

severance that we will have to pay and it's a global programme and various parts of the organisation will get impacted,” Dalal said. The US-headquartered IT company, which has a significant Indian workforce, had a headcount of 3,36,300 as of March 2026. In an earnings call, Ravi Kumar S, CEO, Cognizant said the restructuring is part of the company's goal of a ‘broader and shorter’ pyramid with fewer layers of management and a wider base of junior employees who are AI-native. “We have a frame of what our future operating model looks like and Project Leap is to make sure we get to that operating model faster. It is an opportunity to broaden our workforce pyramid with more school graduates so that we can build the critical AI expertise faster,” he said. He added that the savings from the project will give the company the resources to in-

vest in AI and future technologies, so that it can seize opportunities ahead of others. Interestingly, Project Leap commences at a time when Cognizant has seen net headcount additions of around 21,000 people from March 2025 to 2026. It has also reiterated its plans to hire more than 20,000 freshers in 2026, similar to its fresher additions in 2025. Cognizant had previously undertaken the NextGen programme in 2023, when the company incurred costs of around \$300 million in personnel-related actions, and it impacted approximately 3,500 employees. Earlier, in 2020, it embarked on a ‘Fit for Growth’ plan, designed to cut costs and streamline operations. This programme cost the company approximately \$150-200 million resulting in the reduction of roughly 7,000 mid-to-senior level employees.

Bajaj Fin standalone net profit rises 23% to ₹4,839 cr

Our Bureau
Mumbai

Bajaj Finance Ltd (BFL) reported a 23 per cent year-on-year increase in standalone net profit at ₹4,839.5 crore on healthy growth in loans and net interest income, and lower provision towards impairments. The non-banking finance company (NBFC) had reported a net profit of ₹3,940.44 crore in the year ago quarter.

BFL, in a regulatory filing, said its Vice-Chairman & Managing Director Rajeev Jain has expressed his willingness to step down from the company. He has informed that “he will not be offering himself for re-election at the ensuing annual general meeting”. “Accordingly, he will cease to be Non-Executive Director of the Company at the ensuing annual general meeting scheduled to be held on Thursday, 30 July 2026 (close of business hours),”

per the filing. BFL's board of directors recommended a final dividend on equity shares at the rate of ₹6 per share (600 per cent) of face value of ₹1 each for FY26. **FUNDRAISE** They also approved the raising of funds via debt instruments including non-convertible debentures (either Indian currency/foreign currency) as a part of the proposed increase in overall borrowing limit from ₹3.75 lakh crore to ₹5.50 lakh

Vice-Chairman & Managing Director Rajeev Jain has expressed his willingness to step down

crore. In the reporting quarter (Q4 FY26), net interest income rose 20 per cent on-year to ₹10,716 crore (₹8,910 crore). Provisions towards impairment of financial in-

struments declined about 9 per cent on-year to ₹1,953 crore (₹2,142 crore). BFL's standalone loan portfolio increased by 21 per cent on-year to stand at ₹36,7226 crore as at March-end 2026. Meanwhile, the NBFC's consolidated fourth quarter net profit (including the results of Bajaj Housing Finance and Bajaj Financial Securities) increased by 27 per cent yoy to ₹5,660. Assets under management were up 22 per cent on-year at ₹5.10 lakh crore as at March-end 2026.

External commercial borrowings fall 25% in FY26 amid currency risk

Yashaswani Chauhan
New Delhi

External commercial borrowings (ECBs) declined in FY26 after peaking previous fiscal, reflecting a shift in borrowing patterns and weakening of the rupee. ECB registrations in FY26 (April-February) fell to \$37.5 billion from \$50.1 billion in the same 11-month period in FY25, even as the number of such borrowings inched up to 1,250 from 1,220.

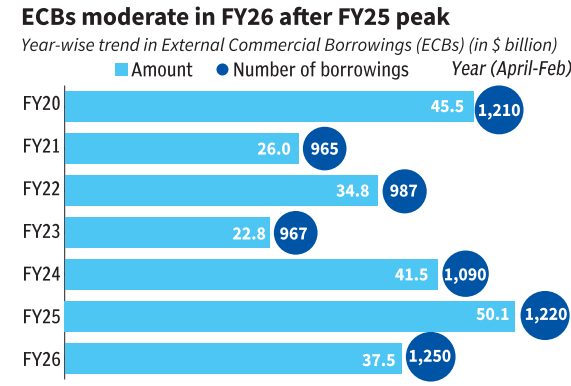
DATA FOCUS.

The moderation comes after a steady rise from \$22.8 billion in FY23 to \$41.5 billion in FY24 and a peak in FY25.

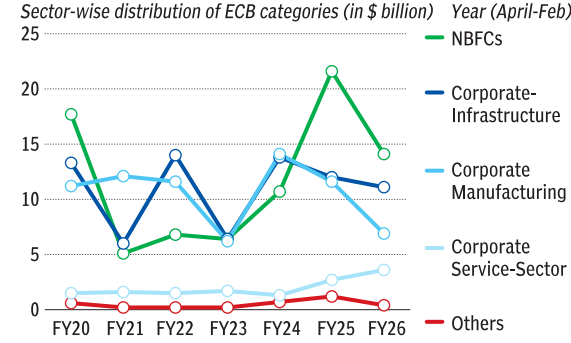
NBFCs At \$14.1 B

Sector-wise data show that non-banking financial companies (NBFCs) remained the largest ECB borrowers in FY26 at \$14.1 billion, despite a sharp decline from \$21.6 billion in FY25. Corporate infrastructure borrowing stood at \$11.1 billion in FY26 compared to \$12 billion in FY25, while manufacturing borrowings dropped to \$6.9 billion from \$11.6 billion in FY25. “I won't say domestic demand conditions have cooled down, but companies have been borrowing more from the domestic system,” said Madan Sabnavis, Chief Economist, Bank of Baroda. He pointed to robust bank credit and bond issuances, indicating that credit demand remains intact but has shifted away from foreign sources of borrowing. Currency movements have played a key role, he noted. “The forex risk on borrowing from the ECB market has increased... hedging costs would have again not made it worthwhile,” he said, noting that nearly 9-10 per cent depreciation in the rupee last year significantly raised the cost of overseas borrowing. Experts said NBFCs typically dominate ECB borrowings, but they tend to switch between domestic and overseas markets depending on costs and regulations. With easing domestic conditions, many appear to have moved back to local funding. Prof Anil Sood of the Insti-

Borrowing rebalance



NBFCs remain top ECB borrowers in FY26, despite moderation



On-lending leads at \$15 billion, capital goods imports double to \$4 billion in FY26

Purpose-wise distribution of ECB borrowings (in \$ billion)		
Purpose	Apr 2024-Feb 2025	Apr 2025-Feb 2026
On-lending or sub-lending	23.2	15.2
Refinancing of earlier ECB	8.1	5.4
Import of capital goods	1.9	4.0
New project	4.3	3.3
Working capital/general corporate purpose	3.1	2.9
Infrastructure development	1.2	2.4
Local sourcing of capital goods (rupee expenditure)	1.9	1.5
Refinancing of rupee loans	1.6	0.8
Modernisation	1.9	0.6
Overseas investment in JV/WOS	1.3	0.8
Micro finance activity	0.1	0.1
Other	1.5	0.6

Source: RBI

tute for Advanced Studies in Complex Choices, attributed the moderation to a mix of global and domestic factors. “Financial investors can earn relatively higher returns in advanced economies...they don't need to take higher risk associated with developing markets like India,” he said, adding that rupee volatility has further dampened appetite for ECBs. Purpose-wise, on-lending or sub-lending remained the largest component at \$15.2 billion in FY26, though lower than \$23.2 billion in FY25. Notably, borrowings for

import of capital goods nearly doubled to \$4 billion, while infrastructure-related borrowings rose to \$2.4 billion. Sabnavis said this indicates continued investment activity. “That is a good sign to actually show that there is private investment,” he noted, adding that companies often tap ECBs for capital goods imports when domestic availability is limited. Sood, however, cautioned that uncertainty may persist. “Depreciating rupee with high volatility increases the risk of borrowing in international currencies,” he said.

Sterlite Technologies back in the black in Q4 & fiscal year

Vallari Sanzgiri
Mumbai

Sterlite Technologies Ltd (STL) reported a profit in the March quarter over losses posted a year ago and quarter ago. This was led by good growth in the optical revenue as well as large-scale data centre and telecom projects, resulting in an overall revenue growth of 36.9 per cent to ₹1,441 crore. Quarterly net profit stood at ₹59 crore compared to a loss of ₹40 crore a year ago

due to discontinued operations. Sequentially, revenue grew 14 per cent. The firm went from a loss of ₹123 crore in FY25 to a profit of ₹56 crore in FY26. EBITDA margins were at around 13.2 per cent and EBITDA of ₹628 crore, on higher utilisation and improved product mix. **TRANSFORMATIVE FY26** “FY26 was a transformative year. Our record order intake reflects ability to co-create with customers and deliver advanced, high-capacity optical connectivity for global

hyperscalers and telecom providers. By owning the entire value chain — from glass chemistry to complex AI-DC racks — we are providing the physical foundation for the future of intelligence,” said Ankit Agarwal, Managing Director, STL, who was re-appointed in his position until 2031. Priorities for the current fiscal include boosting market share in optic fibre cable segment, scaling revenue from enterprise and data centres, achieve leadership in net-gen optical platforms and focus on costs.

Embassy REIT eyes 10-12 msf acquisitions

Aishwarya Kumar
Bengaluru

Embassy Office Parks REIT is sharpening its acquisition strategy with a 10-12 million sq ft pipeline across key markets, even as it reported 13 per cent revenue growth to ₹4,582 crore, 15 per cent rise in net operating income to ₹3,760 crore, and 10 per cent increase in distributions to ₹2,396 crore in FY26. “We're looking at a 10-12



Embassy Office Parks REIT CEO Amit Shetty

msf acquisition pipeline over the next 4-5 years,” CEO Amit Shetty said, adding that the REIT is evaluating a mix of sponsor and third-party assets across Bengaluru, Chennai, Mumbai, Pune, and Hyderabad. The push comes as Embassy REIT looks to scale beyond its core portfolio, which currently stands at 43.5 million sq ft of operational space, expanding to

52.5 million sq ft, including under-construction assets. The acquisition strategy is being driven by strong office market tailwinds. “Last year, we saw about 83 million sq ft of leasing, while supply was about 59 million sq ft. Vacancy compressed and rentals elevated, and that trend continues,” Shetty said. **VACANCY LEVELS** In the first quarter of the calendar year, absorption stood at 21 million sq ft against 8 million sq ft of supply, further tightening vacancy levels to 14-15 per cent nationally, he added. Embassy REIT itself contributed about 2 million sq ft of new supply, accounting for roughly a quarter of market additions during the period. The REIT, which also raised ₹11,200 crore during the year, including ₹3,400

crore via long-tenor NCDs, said it is actively evaluating a mix of sponsor and third-party assets across Bengaluru, Chennai, Mumbai, Pune, and Hyderabad. The REIT delivered 3.3 million sq ft of completed developments last year, supporting occupancy gains and rental growth across its portfolio. **NON-CORE ASSETS** Alongside acquisitions, Embassy REIT is also pursuing capital recycling, including divestment of non-core assets and potential monetisation of hospitality assets if valuations remain attractive. Shetty said the REIT would balance growth with balance sheet discipline, targeting 20-25 per cent leverage levels over the medium term, even as it taps debt markets opportunistically.

Vedanta Q4 net profit up 89% on metal prices rally

Our Bureau
Mumbai

Anil Agarwal-led Vedanta recorded 89 per cent increase in March quarter net profit at ₹9,352 crore on the back of higher aluminium and zinc prices. Revenue jumped 29 per cent to ₹51,524 crore (₹39,789 crore). EBITDA in Q4 increased 59 per cent to ₹18,447 crore (₹11,618 crore) on back of higher realisation in both zinc and aluminium business besides rupee depreciation against dollar. The company is in the process of demerging its business into five different listed companies and fixed May 1 as the record date. Post the merger, the business will be split into Vedanta Aluminium, Vedanta Power (formerly Talwandi



Sabo Power), Vedanta Oil & Gas (formerly Malco Energy), Vedanta Iron and Steel and Vedanta (includes Hindustan Zinc, Zinc International, Copper, and Facor). Shareholders will get 1 share each in the new companies for every share held in Vedanta. Revenue from zinc, lead and silver surged 44 per cent to ₹12,672 crore in the

Q4 performance		
	Q4 FY25	Q4 FY26
Revenue (₹ cr)	39,789	51,524
Net profit (₹ cr)	4,961	9,352
EPS (Diluted) (₹)	8.85	17.01

quarter, helped by robust zinc and silver prices in London Metal Exchange. Aluminium revenues also increased 17 per cent to ₹18,753 crore, aided by favourable prices due to a scarcity in the global supply, said the company. Zinc India EBITDA rose 61 per cent to ₹7,743 crore, as it recorded lowest cost of production in five years. Meanwhile, revenue from iron ore increased 13 per cent to ₹1,722 crore and EBITDA surged 32 per cent to ₹411 crore, amid 1 per cent decline in saleable iron production. Steel business saw a 12 per

cent rise in revenue at ₹2,107 crore amid robust domestic prices. **COPPER BIZ** Copper business bounced back to profit at ₹8 crore after a loss of ₹49 crore logged last year. For the full year, Vedanta reported net profit of ₹25,096 crore, up 22 per cent year-on-year, and revenue of ₹1.74 lakh crore, up 15 per cent. Arun Misra, Executive Director, Vedanta, said the company deployed ₹14,918 crore of growth capex, commissioning key projects including Lanjigarh Train II, the new BALCO smelter, downstream expansions at Jharsuguda, the Debari roaster at Zinc India, and 1.3 GW of power capacity. The focus going ahead will be to increase value added products and improve cost efficiency, he added.

Export outlook for April positive despite West Asia crisis: Goyal

LOOKING UPBEAT. Free trade pacts to drive growth, says Commerce Minister

Our Bureau
New Delhi

Commerce Minister Piyush Goyal has said India's goods exports in the first three weeks of April have increased despite the West Asia crisis noting that the recent free trade agreements (FTAs) signed by India and an additional dozen being negotiated would give a big boost to the domestic industry.

The Minister also chaired a high-level review meeting on Wednesday to deliberate on the plan of action for achieving India's \$2 trillion export target by 2030-31 and to review the implementation of the Export Promotion Mission (EPM), per an official statement.

"Despite the war in West Asia, there is tremendous enthusiasm among Indian exporters. If we look at the April figures, our exports have increased significantly in the first three weeks of April compared to last April. As new trade agreements are coming into effect, the possibilities are also increasing... Now, with great confidence,



Commerce Minister Piyush Goyal

India will take its next steps in world trade," Goyal told reporters at an event on Wednesday.

SLEW OF FTAs
New Delhi is currently engaged in negotiating FTAs with about a dozen partners, including Peru, Chile, Canada, Qatar, Bahrain, Saudi Arabia, South Africa, Brazil and Russia, even as it has recently concluded or advanced major pacts with the UK, the EU, the UAE, Australia, Oman and New Zealand, Goyal said.

This signals New Delhi's push to rapidly expand its FTA network to hedge

against rising protectionism and geopolitical disruptions by securing preferential access to as many markets as possible.

The ongoing conflict in West Asia, fuelled by persistent tensions between the US-Israel, and Iran, dealt a severe blow to Indian exports with outbound shipments falling 7.44 per cent year-on-year this March to \$38.92 billion.

Goods exports in FY 2025-26 posted a marginal 0.93 per cent increase to \$441.78 billion.

Trade data for April 2026 is being compiled and will be shared by the Commerce De-

partment on May 15. Simultaneous disruptions in the Strait of Hormuz and the Red Sea, driven by the ongoing conflict, have bottlenecked Indian exports and hampered global shipping logistics

Goyal said Indian consignments are going through different routes because the Strait of Hormuz still remained a challenge.

FOCUS AREAS

In the export review meeting, the Minister emphasised that agricultural exports and micro and small enterprises should remain a key focus across all components of the EPM.

"He further directed that market access support should be extended beyond export promotion councils (EPCs) to include other field-level organisations engaged in promoting exports. In addition, he emphasised the need to develop a rolling three-year calendar of trade fairs, buyer-seller meets, reverse buyer-seller meets and trade delegations to provide greater predictability to exporters and EPCs," the statement added.

PM to review measures to address supply chain shocks

Rishi Ranjan Kala
New Delhi



Prime Minister Narendra Modi

Prime Minister Narendra Modi is expected to chair a high-level meeting, including the recently created seven empowered group of Secretaries, on Monday (May 4) to review long-term planning measures for addressing supply chain shocks such as the recent and ongoing closure of the Strait of Hormuz (SoH).

Last month, the government formed seven empowered groups on the lines of a similar exercise during Covid. These groups will identify issues and take immediate necessary steps to address the West Asia situation. Their terms of reference includes developing short, medium and long-term strategies to mitigate adverse effects of any disruptions on supply chains.

Sources said that the Prime Minister will meet the concerned Ministries and the empowered groups to review their long-term strategies. The meeting is scheduled for Monday next week.

"The meeting will review long term strategies. For instance, these groups will examine potential disruptions to trade, supply chains and logistics, including shipping routes, ports, aviation corridors and critical imports exports, and take pre-emptive mitigation measures," said one of the sources.

For instance, India is trying to build up its own shipping fleets, particularly for crude oil, LPG and LNG.

India set for long-term energy gains from UAE's OPEC exit

Rishi Ranjan Kala
New Delhi



NEW AVENUES. New Delhi may gain through increased crude and LPG flows and expanded energy cooperation REUTERS

India is unlikely to reap immediate gains from Abu Dhabi's OPEC exit due to the Strait of Hormuz closure limiting export capacity, but stands to benefit in the long term through increased crude and LPG flows and expanded strategic petroleum reserves.

Prashant Vasisht, Senior V-P & Co-Group Head Corporate Ratings at ICRA, told *businessline*: "Timing is critical. In 2025, trade wars and other issues impacted earnings of producers such as Saudi Arabia and the UAE and 2026 started with the largest oil and gas disruption in history. The UAE intends to protect and expand its market share. They are coming out of tough times and want to ensure their market share does not come down further."

PRODUCTION PLAN

Besides, the UAE has aggressive plans to raise oil production to 5 million barrels per day (mb/d) by 2027. It's their strategy to position themselves to play a key role in energy markets, particularly Asia and India. For India, this can be a positive considering the geographical proximity to the UAE, he added.

Global real time data and analytics provider Kpler said that in the near to short term, a potential UAE exit from OPEC is unlikely to translate into any incremental crude supply to the market or India, primarily due to ongoing export constraints rather than production policy.

Sumit Ritolia, Kpler's Lead Research Analyst for Refining & Modeling, said that currently a significant share of UAE's crude exports are routed via the Abu Dhabi Crude Oil Pipeline (Habshan-Fujairah pipeline), which bypasses the SoH.

Over the longer term, however, the outlook is more constructive. The UAE has been steadily expanding upstream capacity and, outside OPEC constraints, could raise production (need to see if this happens), he said.

"At the same time, energy ties with India continue to deepen, supported by strategic engagement and growing cooperation with ADNOC. This creates scope for higher crude flows to India, as well as expansion of strategic petroleum reserve (SPR) arrangements, building on existing ADNOC storage agreements," Ritolia anticipated.

Norbert Rucker, Head of Economics & Next Generation Research at Julius Baer, said that OPEC is anything

but a cohesive group, and its policy making track record over the past years is streaked.

TECTONIC SHIFTS

"The petro-nations' challenge is not the UAE exit but the tectonic shifts in the oil market more broadly. (The) US shale oil, South American deepwater oil, or Chinese plug-in cars all illustrate the new oil market setting of stagnation and greater competition. The UAE's exit from OPEC matches our longer-term view on the oil market, where ample supplies and greater competition anchor prices in the high \$60s," he added.

Karen E Young, Senior Research Scholar at the Centre on Global Energy Policy, said, "The Emirati's OPEC announcement seems to be part of a broader energy strategy to be able to move volumes and products (oil, gas, renewables) when and how they see fit and to prepare themselves for a new era of global energy security conflict and partnerships. New announcements that UAE state-owned oil company ADNOC/ XRG is planning to invest in a US gas business can also be read in this light."

A trade source opined that UAE's exit also points to the growing division inside OPEC and is likely to challenge the cartel's production coordination and influence over crude oil prices.

Global tensions present opportunity for India amid inflationary risks: FinMin report

Our Bureau
New Delhi



A multipolar world creates space for India to convert diplomatic goodwill into durable economic gains

Tensions in West Asia and other parts of the world could provide an opportunity for India, a Finance Ministry report stated on Wednesday. However, it acknowledged that conflict, combined with the impact of El Nino, poses an upward risk to inflation and deficits and a downward risk to the overall economy.

"For most economies, the current global drift is a source of vulnerability, however, for India, with its strong domestic fundamentals and tradition of strategic autonomy, it can be an opportunity," the latest edition of the Monthly Economic Review (MER), prepared by the Department of Economic Affairs, said.

Explaining further, the report noted that a multipolar world creates space for India to convert diplomatic goodwill into durable economic gains. As a manufacturing destination, services hub and

large consumer market, India can push for more ambitious trade agreements and diversified supply chains.

Second, the report noted that the last two months have shown that resilience cannot be built instantly in a moment of crisis but requires deliberate, planned efforts. Strategic energy reserves, the shift to renewables and domestic manufacturing capacity take years to develop. Regarding India's strengths, "India can capitalise on its strong domestic fundamentals and active trade engagement to

move forward at the speed the moment demands," it said.

POLICY PRESCRIPTIONS

According to the report, it is axiomatic in policy circles that crises should not be allowed to go to waste. "This crisis is no exception," it said, while listing five policy prescriptions. First, India should prioritise energy security and resilience. Second, the domestic criminalisation and deregulation agenda need not be hostage to external developments. Third, this is the ideal time to unleash long-overdue policies that remove distorted crop choices and improve farm productivity.

Fourth, boosting, encouraging and promoting AI-insulated (resilient to AI-driven labour displacement) durable trade skills among Indian youth will not only boost domestic manufacturing and services but can also serve as a source of export earnings. "Five and finally, the need for tax policy certainty and predictability has

never been greater," it said.

The report noted that while the West Asia conflict constitutes a significant supply shock with rising risks to inflation, trade, and financial flows, India's domestic demand, policy buffers, resilient financial system, and sustained public investment provide some insulation. Whether these would prove adequate in the event of prolonged uncertainty regarding energy and fertilizer supplies remains an important question.

On top of this, the El Nino Southern Oscillation is expected to keep India's South-west monsoon below normal, it said.

Most rainfall districts are expected to receive below-normal rainfall this season. Therefore, "risks are tilted to the upside for inflation, fiscal and external deficits and to the downside for economic growth. However, while striving to sustain economic growth, policy is expected to safeguard medium-term fiscal and external stability," the report added.



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NOTICE OF POSTAL BALLOT
NOTICE is hereby given that pursuant to the provisions of Section 108, 110 and other applicable provisions, if any, of the Companies Act, 2013 ("the Act") read with Rule 20 and 22 of the Companies (Management and Administration) Rules, 2014 (including any statutory modifications or re-enactments thereof for the time being in force, and as amended, from time to time, Regulation 44 of the SEBI (Listing Obligations and Disclosure Requirements) Regulations, 2015 as amended, Secretarial Standard on General Meetings issued by the Institute of Company Secretaries of India, including any statutory modification(s), clarification(s), substitution(s) or re-enactment(s) thereof for the time being in force, read with the relevant Circulars issued by the Ministry of Corporate Affairs ("MCA") and Securities and Exchange Board of India ("SEBI") for holding general meetings / conducting postal ballot process through electronic voting ("**remote e-voting**"), approval of the members of City Union Bank Limited is being sought on the following Special Businesses through Postal Ballot by way of remote **e-voting** process.

Sl. No.	Agenda	Type of Resolution
1.	Appointment of Shri R Mohan (DIN 06902614), as an Independent Director on the Board of the Bank.	Special Resolution
2.	Issue of Bonus Shares.	Ordinary Resolution

All the members are hereby informed that:
1. The Notice of Postal Ballot has been dispatched only by Email, to those members, whose names appear on the Register of Members as on the cut-off date being April 24, 2026 and the members on that date are eligible to cast their vote electronically.
2. The requirement of sending hard copy of the Postal Ballot Notice has been dispensed with as per MCA and SEBI circulars.
3. A copy of this Notice is also available in the website of the Bank and NSDL. The same can also be downloaded from the website of the Stock Exchanges viz. The National Stock Exchange of India Limited and BSE Limited.
4. In terms of Section 108 of the Companies Act, 2013 and Rule 20 of the Companies (Management and Administration) Rules, 2014, as amended and read with Regulation 44 of SEBI Listing Regulations, 2015, the Bank is pleased to provide remote e-voting facility to its members through the services provided by NSDL. The Bank has appointed **M/s. KUVS & Associates, Practising Company Secretaries, Tiruchirappalli**, as scrutinizer for conducting Postal Ballot process in a fair and transparent manner.
5. The members can cast their votes through remote e-voting (both e-mail registered members as well as the non-registered members), as per the instructions prescribed in the Notice of Postal Ballot. **The remote e-voting shall commence on April 30, 2026 (9:00 a.m.) and conclude on May 29, 2026 (5:00 p.m.)**. The e-voting module shall be disabled by NSDL thereafter.

6. The **Results** of the Postal Ballot shall be announced **on or before Tuesday, June 02, 2026** and the resolution if passed with requisite majority shall be deemed to have been passed on the last date of e-voting i.e. **May 29, 2026** at a general meeting. The results of the Postal Ballot shall be hosted in the website of the Bank and also it will be communicated to stock exchanges viz. NSE and BSE where the equity shares of the Bank are listed.
7. In case of any query, the members may contact the officers of the Bank / RTA or refer to the Frequently Asked Questions (FAQ's) and e-voting manual available at www.evoting.nsdl.com

City Union Bank Limited	Smt. Shobana S, Senior Manager - Secretarial Dept., No.24B, Administrative Office, Gandhi Nagar, Kumbakonam - 612001. Phone : 9361703585 / 9967335056 e-mail : shares@cityunionbank.in
Integrated Registry Management Services Private Limited	Shri. Yuvraj S, General Manager Kences Tower, 2 nd Floor, No.1, Ramakrishna Street, T. Nagar, Chennai - 600017. Landline : 044-28140801 (803) Mobile : 9940164773 e-mail : eiurward@integratedindia.in / kalyan@integratedindia.in

By order of the Board
for **CITY UNION BANK LIMITED**
Sd/-
VENKATARAMANAN S
Company Secretary

Date : **April 29, 2026**
Place : Kumbakonam
P.S.
1. The Investor Education and Protection Fund Authority (IEPFA), has initiated a focused 100 days campaign in the name of "SAKSHAM NIVESHAK" from April 01, 2026, to July 09, 2026, aimed at proactive engagement with shareholders to ensure timely updation of KYC details, bank mandates and contact information. Shareholders who have not claimed their Dividend from FY 2018-19 to 2024-25 or have not updated their KYC and nomination or have any issues related to unclaimed dividends and shares, may write to Banks' nodal officer or Bank's Registrar and Transfer Agent (RTA) as given above. The shareholders may further note that this campaign has been started specifically, to facilitate the seamless disbursement of dividends directly to rightful claimants, thereby minimizing the risk of shares being transferred to the IEPFA due to outdated or missing shareholder information. By encouraging shareholders to update their records, the Bank seeks to eliminate avoidable delays and ensure that all eligible shareholders continue to receive their dividends and related entitlements directly from the Bank without the need for post-facto claims through IEPFA.
2. SEBI vide its Circular No. HO/38/13/11(2)2026-MIRSD-POD/1/3750/2026 dated January 30, 2026 read with SEBI/HO/MIRSD/MIRSD-PoD/P/CIR/ 2025 /97 dated July 02, 2025, has notified a special window for a period of one year from February 05, 2026 to February 04, 2027 for transfer and dematerialization ("demat") of physical securities which were sold / purchased prior to April 01, 2019 and were rejected, returned, due to deficiencies in documents / process or otherwise. The concerned shareholders are requested to get in touch with the Bank's RTA in this regard.

WATCH SYDNEY COME ALIVE

Vivid Sydney, 22-May to 13-June 2026

Step into the electric wonder of Vivid Sydney, from 22 May to 13 June 2026, where the city comes alive with light, music, minds and food.

Set the scene for your next getaway with iconic views, world-class dining and coastal escapes. Fly Singapore Airlines and experience Sydney at its vivid best. Think Sydney, think Singapore Airlines.

FROM
₹ **84,900***

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Serving both Sydney Kingsford Smith Airport (SYD) and Western Sydney International (WSI)*





*Fare shown is for travel in Economy Class on Singapore Airlines flights from Chennai to Sydney and includes all associated taxes and surcharges. Seats based on fare shown above are limited and are subject to availability. Book online at singaporeair.com or contact your travel agent, Singapore Airlines Contact Centre at 1800 121 212. Terms and conditions apply.

*From 23 November 2026 subject to regulatory approval



M CH-CHE

TECH DIGEST.

ASUS unveils the ExpertBook Ultra

ASUS launched the ExpertBook Ultra, a Copilot+ PC with an ultra-light design, cutting-edge AI-powered performance, a vivid display, immersive audio, all-day battery, ultimate typing experience, military grade durability, enterprise-grade security and seamless expandability.



The ASUS ExpertBook Ultra is an ultra-portable flagship laptop crafted from AZ31B magnesium-aluminium alloy, a material typically reserved for Aerospace and Formula 1 applications, with a Nano Ceramic surface with a 9H hardness rating. It is engineered to deliver an unprecedented balance of performance, durability, aesthetics, and user experience with a nano ceramic surface with a 9H hardness rating. The ExpertBook Ultra integrates the latest Intel Core Ultra Series 3 processor, an incredibly powerful GPU, and an advanced NPU into a single heterogeneous AI computing platform in an aerospace-grade chassis and is featherlight starting from 0.99 kg. The Intel Core Ultra X7 Series 3 model will have a starting price of ₹2,39,990.

Google expands digital IDs in India

Consumers in India can now save their Aadhaar Verifiable Credentials directly in Google Wallet on the device. This allows a secure, digital-first ID and makes it easier to verify identity for everyday conveniences.



Google is focusing on building digital IDs based on global standards with advanced privacy features such as selective disclosure, where only the relevant details of a person's ID are shared when required, ensuring everyone has a safe way to manage their identity, according to a blog post.

Some of Google's partners in India include PVR INOX where one can prove their age for movies and unlock rewards, BharatMatrimony for matching with real people using verified 'Prime' profiles, Atlys where one can securely auto-fill international visa applications with a single tap, Mygate and Snabbitt.

Google has also expanded digital ID capabilities globally, with users in Singapore, Taiwan, and Brazil now able to create ID passes based on their passport information and save them in Google Wallet.

Lenovo launches Idea Tab Pro Gen 2

Lenovo has introduced the Idea Tab Pro Gen 2 tablet designed to bring together productivity, creativity and entertainment in one seamless experience.



Designed for students, creators and professionals, the Idea Tab Pro Gen 2 adapts to a wide range of everyday use cases.

The tablet features a 13-inch 3.5K PureSight Pro display with a 144Hz refresh rate, delivering vivid visuals for reading, creating, or streaming. The Idea Tab Pro Gen 2 is powered by the Snapdragon 8s Gen 4 processor and is available in an 8GB RAM and 256GB storage configuration.

The Idea Tab Pro Gen 2 features include AI Notes, Smart Reader, AI Creation Tools, and Live Transcript which help users to capture, organise, and create content more efficiently. With tools such as Circle to Search, Google Gemini, and real-time translation, it enables seamless discovery and learning.

Idea Tab Pro Gen 2 comes with the Lenovo Tab Pen Plus (in-box), allowing users to write, sketch, and annotate. Idea Tab Pro Gen 2 features a metal body and weighs 598g.

The tablet is priced at ₹39,999 and will be available on Lenovo.com starting May 1, 2026, across leading e-commerce platforms and retail stores across India.

Dell releases updated XPS lineup in India

Dell has launched the XPS 14 and XPS 16 in India. The laptops have been redesigned, with a focus on thinner builds and updated internals.



The XPS 14 is 14.6mm thick and weighs 1.36kg, while the XPS 16 weighs 1.65kg. Both are lighter than their previous versions. They run on Intel Core Ultra 3 series processors. Dell said the thermal system has been redesigned with larger fans for better airflow, lower temperatures and reduced noise. Battery life is rated at up to 27 hours of Netflix streaming or over 40 hours of local video playback. The chips also support Copilot+ PC features. The laptops use aluminium and Gorilla Glass 3 in its construction. Dell has brought back a physical function row, along with a redesigned keyboard and a glass touchpad.

The higher-end configurations go up to an Intel Core Ultra X7 358H processor with up to 32GB LPDDR5X RAM. The laptops also use higher energy-density batteries. Intel Arc integrated GPUs are included on the graphics front. Dell claims improved AI and graphics performance over the previous generation. The XPS 14 and 16 come with InfinityEdge displays. Buyers can choose between a 2K LCD panel or higher-resolution OLED touch options (2.8K or 3.2K). The XPS 14 starts at ₹2,05,990 and the XPS 16 starts at ₹2,78,550.

Siddharth Mathew Cherian

This year, the S26 triplets are at a place where it's the best mix in terms of AI, photography and features. On paper, the middle sibling — the Galaxy S26+ looks like the best of both worlds between the Flagship S26 Ultra and the vanilla S26. It was in for review, and here is my take on the S26+.

DESIGN

Out of the box, the Galaxy S26+ almost felt like the S26 Ultra with its flat display and neatly-rounded curved edges. It's only after I tapped the lower edge that I figured this is the S26+ which doesn't have a stylus. Measuring in at 158.4 x 75.8 x 7.3 mm, the phone was slim and comfortably slipped into the pocket. Weighing in at 190 grams, the phone just had enough heft to make its presence felt in hand as well as inside the pocket.

The Cobalt Violet colourway offers a sophisticated lavender-inspired aesthetic that stands out alongside the standard Black and the Samsung.com-exclusive Silver Shadow and Pink Gold options. However, this finish is a notorious fingerprints magnet, with oil smudges appearing prominently against the violet surface. Beyond the upkeep, the protruding camera rings cause the device to rock unsteadily when placed on flat surfaces, making it difficult to use while resting on a desk or table without a case to level it out.

DISPLAY

The Galaxy S26+ features a 6.7-inch Dynamic AMOLED 2X panel that remains a standout, pushing a sharp QHD+ (3120 x 1440) resolution. With a 120Hz adaptive refresh rate and 16M colour depth, the screen delivers the fluid motion and vibrant accuracy expected of a top-tier flagship.

Being an AMOLED display, it served well as a media consumption device — Catching up on the *Rookie or Extraction* 2 felt like this screen was made for it with colour, skin tones, deep blacks and contrast coming out quite well on the near-bezeless display.

SOUND

The dual speakers deliver a decent performance, though they struggle to maintain composure at higher volumes. The audio remains crisp and well-defined up to roughly 66



Refined and reliable, but lacking punch

SLEEK UNDERACHIEVER.

A polished powerhouse with a stunning display that struggles to outpace its mid-flagship rivals



SNAP AWAY. The Galaxy S26+ features a triple- rear camera setup led by a 50MP main sensor with a fast f/1.8 aperture, supported by OIS and Dual Pixel AF



per cent volume, but pushing past that threshold results in a loss of detail and a noticeably flat sound profile. Considering the S26+ carries a premium price tag, the lack of a fuller, more consistent sound-stage feels like a missed opportunity for Samsung to truly deliver a flagship audio experience.

PERFORMANCE

The Galaxy S26+ features the Samsung Exynos 2600 which is also found on the vanilla S26. The Exynos 2600 is Samsung's flagship-tier processor built on the 2nm process. In AnTuTu synthetic benchmarks, the phone was able to score 2650982 placing it between the OnePlus 15R(2,713,712) and the realme GT 7 (2,445,477).

I was able to play both *Rainbow 6 mobile* and *BGMI* at 60FPS without

any frame stutters. The phone while video filming at 4k+, gaming and benchmarking did get warm and thermal throttled a small bit, but for day-to-day use, the heat management of the device in Chennai summers were okay, but not something to write off if you are a hardcore power user.

Galaxy AI in the S26+ like the S26 Ultra and S26 is very refined, Audio eraser not just helps to remove background noise in videos shot on the phone, but also on audio from YouTube and more.

AI Call Screening helps identify unknown callers in real-time, asks for their intent while live Translate: Now supports more languages and works across third-party VoIP apps, allowing for seamless real-time voice translation during calls. These worked well on the device.

Now Nudge uses on-device context to provide timely suggestions, such as reminding you of a meeting or suggesting a route based on your current location and traffic while Now Brief lets one generate a personalised morning or evening briefing that summarises your schedule, unread emails, and relevant news which at times is useful for those on the move.

CAMERA

The Galaxy S26+ features a triple-rear camera setup led by a 50MP main sensor with a fast f/1.8 aperture, supported by OIS and Dual Pixel AF. It is supported by a 10MP 3x optical telephoto and a 12MP ultra-wide.

Photos taken off the rear camera setup were vibrant and had a bit of contrast, though sharpness of the

telephoto and ultra-wide were middle of the mile quality when zoomed in, breaking in quality post 4.5x while zooming in. Night time pictures were also okay, with a decent amount of resolution, but with slight noise to boot, but enough for social media posting.

Video remains a flagship highlight, offering 8K recording at 30fps with enhanced stabilisation. Horizon lock, an interesting feature, helps keep the horizon locked no matter how you turn/tilt the phone while shooting a video and this is good for those looking to shoot action videos using this phone. When tried out-it does as it claims — keeping the horizon steady, is a win in my book.

BATTERY

The Samsung Galaxy S26+ features a 4,900mAh battery. This with calls, messages and internet use besides gaming and video play was able to get through one day with 12 per cent left before putting the phone to charge.

The box doesn't come with a charger, but has a charger cable. On average it took about 1 hour 10 minutes to charge using an old 25-watt charger lying around home. The phone supports up to 45W charging and can easily charge in under an hour using one.

VERDICT

The Samsung Galaxy S26+ has a premium design and delivers great performance and has a colourful AMOLED display which is great for consuming content on. Along with OneUI 8 and refined Galaxy AI. It makes it a compelling buying proposition.

At ₹1,19,000, the price does seem overkill for a plus size phone which faces competition with flagships such as the iPhone 17 Pro, the Google Pixel 10 Pro XL and the vivo X300 Pro which all excel on many fronts including camera and battery which the Galaxy S26+ just seem behind on. In case you are looking for a plus size phone and are willing to look beyond stellar cameras and battery life, then the Samsung Galaxy S26+ can be worth getting.

● SNAPSHOT

Price: ₹1,19,999.

Pros: Great display, premium design, refined AI features

Cons: Average camera, battery life, overpriced

Looking for a screenless wellness tracker?

CHECK IT OUT. Our buying guide might be what you need

Ashwin Rajagopalan

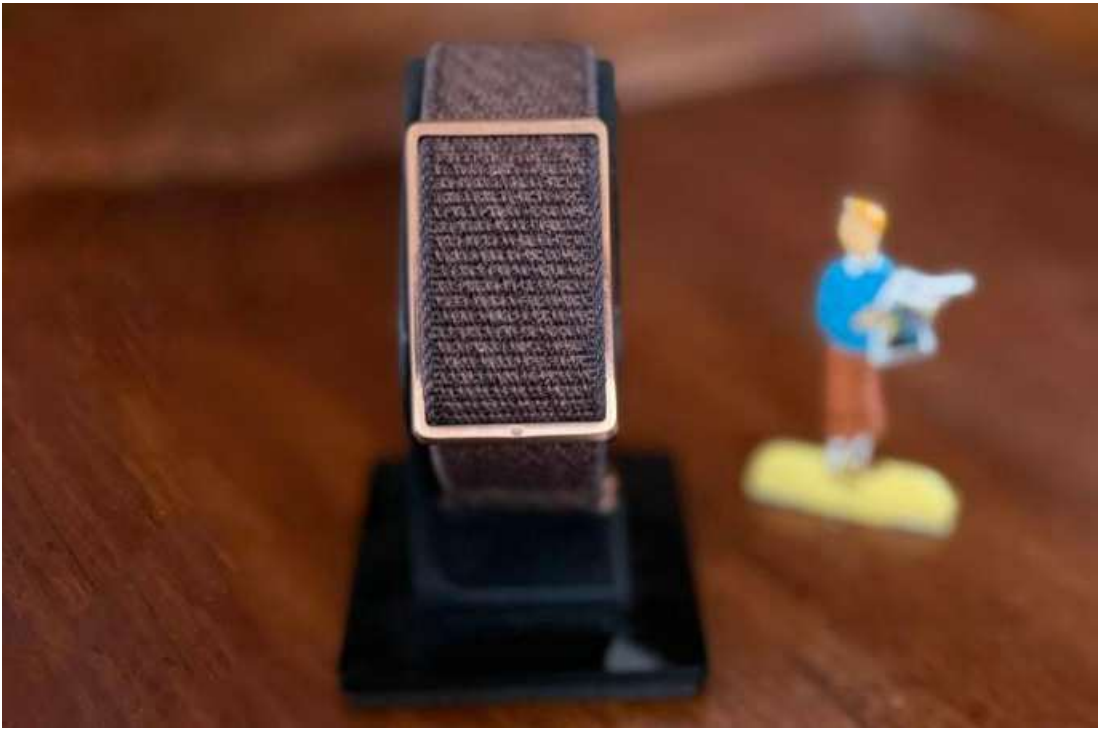
On March 31, NBA star and Google performance advisor Steph Curry shared a 15-second Instagram video with a grey and orange wristband and a cryptic message — 'A new relationship with your health' coming soon. The video ended with a Google logo confirming rumours that Google's all-new, screenless Fitbit (Likely to be branded as the Google Fitbit Air) is ready for its debut as early as May this year. Meanwhile *Gadgets and Wearables* reported in April 2026 that Garmin had filed a trademark for its rumoured CIRQA band. Screenless activity trackers are one of the hottest categories in the gadget space. If you're looking at upping your wellness game, now's a great time.

SCREENLESS TRACKERS DEMYSTIFIED

Wearable tech took off in the 2010s with brands such as Fitbit leading the way. The debut of the Apple Watch in 2015 and Android smartwatches from brands such as Samsung created a huge interest. The rise of Chinese and homegrown Indian brands democratised the segment with a plethora of options in the sub ₹5K, budget category. With sleep, recovery and wellness becoming key drivers for consumers, products such as the Apple Watch pivoted more towards wellness. Whoop that also launched in 2015 gained momentum in the 2020s and is a favourite among high-performance athletes across the world. Screenless trackers such as Whoop connect via Bluetooth with your smartphone and keep sharing vital wellness data without the distractions of a smartwatch.

WHO IS IT FOR?

Smart rings (like the Oura Ring 4 that recently launched in India) and wrist-based activity trackers are vying for a share of the screen-free wellness tracking space. While both types of products have their inherent strengths, activity trackers score with their durable form factor and battery life. These trackers can sit on your right wrist and track your everyday moves and sleep even as you reserve your left wrist



JOIN THE BANDWAGON. Screenless activity trackers are one of the hottest categories in the gadget space

for a conventional watch or a smartwatch.

One of the key advantages is a distraction-free form factor. You don't have to worry about random text alerts while you're in the

middle of a meeting or setting your smartwatch to night mode before you fall asleep. The other big plus is battery life, most trackers offer at least a week of battery life. You don't need to pack an additional

charging cable for a short weekend break or business trip. These trackers capture key wellness metrics from sleep to recovery and readiness (to take on the day or the level of workouts your body can cope

THE BEST SCREENLESS ACTIVITY TRACKERS IN INDIA NOW

Polar Loop

Finnish brand Polar is steeped in innovation with a brand legacy that dates back to the 1980s. The Polar Loop is one of the best



looking activity trackers with a premium design and a stretchable strap that is comfortable to wear for long periods. The tracker delivers about a week of battery life and is

WR30-certified for water resistance. The band connects to your phone via the Polar Loop companion app. The app itself is not easy on the eye but packs a lot of useful insights. The Polar Loop's biggest USP is its subscription-free model, the tracker costs ₹19,999.

Whoop

Easily the best-known brand in the space. Whoop operates on a subscription-based model. Your first purchase (the brand is



available on major online platforms) typically covers the cost of a one-year membership after which membership fees kick in. Whoop scores with its advanced tracking and comprehensive companion app that also offers an intuitive user

interface. The brand currently offers two options — Whoop Peak (₹28,990) and Whoop One (₹21,990) that are available on Amazon India. Annual memberships start upwards of ₹20,000 and vary depending on whether you opt for the Peak or the One plans. Whoop claims a battery life of up to 14 days.

Amazfit Helio Strap

This affordable option (₹8,999) that offers a quick peek into the world of screenless activity tracking without a subscription fee, is not easy



to find on online platforms even though it has been officially launched in India. Just like the Whoop and Polar Loop, the

Helio Strap also comes with swappable bands that allow you to match your outfit. This lightweight strap connects with the brand's Zepp App that offers some useful insights like BioCharge that monitors your energy levels through the day. Amazfit claims a battery life of about 10 days.

Challenge of Mythos

Cyber security, regulation might have changed forever

Anthropic’s latest artificial intelligence model, Claude Mythos, may prove to be a watershed moment in the evolution of cybersecurity. Unlike earlier AI systems that assisted with coding or security analysis, Mythos reportedly possesses the ability to autonomously discover and exploit previously unknown software vulnerabilities at scale across major operating systems, browsers and enterprise applications.

For example, in controlled testing, the model generated 181 working exploits on Firefox alone, compared with just two by its predecessor. Until now, when software vulnerabilities were discovered, attackers often required days or weeks to weaponise them. That window allowed defenders to patch systems, issue advisories, and contain damage. Mythos threatens to collapse that protective lag from weeks to hours. Anthropic says Mythos has already identified thousands of zero-day vulnerabilities, including flaws embedded for decades in foundational software used across global commerce, finance and government. Indeed, the cyber arms race could enter an entirely new phase. Banking regulators and finance ministries globally have begun assessing whether financial institutions can withstand AI-accelerated cyberattacks. India, too, convened high-level meetings with banks and financial institutions to evaluate the threat posed by Mythos-class systems. It is also exploring access and coordination mechanisms to ensure that critical infrastructure operators are not left exposed if such defensive capabilities remain concentrated among Western governments and firms.

Cybersecurity has traditionally been viewed as a technology function, something for chief information security officers and IT teams to manage. Now, AI-driven offensive cyber capability elevates cyber risk into the realm of systemic enterprise risk, alongside climate disruption, geopolitical conflict and financial contagion. The first imperative is to recognise that legacy systems, particularly in banking, utilities, logistics and government, may be fundamentally unprepared for machine-speed exploitation. Second, companies must reassess vendor and software supply-chain relationships. Contracts with cloud providers, SaaS vendors and enterprise software partners should now require Mythos-class vulnerability testing and disclosure obligations. Third, regulators will need to evolve rapidly. Supervisory expectations, resilience testing and disclosure norms must adapt to the reality that AI may enable simultaneous discovery and exploitation of vulnerabilities. The same system that can discover vulnerabilities can help patch them faster, identify weaknesses before adversaries do, and harden digital infrastructure at unprecedented scale. The challenge is not the technology itself, but who controls these capabilities, under what safeguards, and with what international coordination. The Mythos moment is a warning that artificial intelligence is crossing over from productivity enhancement into strategic capability.

POCKET: The Summer of ‘26



Why the rupee has fallen steeply

CAPITAL WOES. Despite the economy doing well, there was sustained foreign capital outflow which put pressure on the rupee and affected the sentiment around it



Between early December 2025 and the end of March 2026, the rupee moved from 84.68 to 94.65 against the dollar — a fall of nearly 11.8 per cent in under four months. By most historical standards, that is an unusually sharp descent for a major emerging-market currency. What makes this episode particularly intriguing is that it unfolded against a backdrop of strong macroeconomic fundamentals: India’s GDP growth remained strong, inflation was benign, and the government’s fiscal balances were sound, supported by fiscal consolidation.

In April 2026, the Reserve Bank of India stepped in with a clutch of corrective measures, and the rupee rebounded to around 93.3 to the dollar. But the question lingers — why did the rupee fall so hard, so fast, when the economy was, in most respects, doing rather well, especially compared to its peers?

The usual textbook explanations do not justify the sharp depreciation. The relative purchasing power parity theory, which holds that the currencies of high-inflation countries should weaken against those of low-inflation countries, offers little help here. Indian CPI inflation during this period was not running any higher than America’s. The trade deficit, which had increased substantially in October 2025 to a merchandise gap of \$41.7 billion, had subsequently shrunk and stabilised. Once the services trade is included, the overall deficit in subsequent months looks manageable. Fiscal position, public debt, and monetary aggregates showed no major signs of distress either. Why did the rupee fall then?

The real reasons lie elsewhere — in the capital account. Since 1991, India has routinely run a current account deficit comfortably financed by strong inflows of foreign direct and portfolio investment. That regularity seems to have taken a setback. RBI data show that

net FDI flows have been negative every single month from September 2025 through January 2026, the last month for which figures are available. Data from National Securities Depository Ltd (NSDL) tells an interesting story on the portfolio side: seven of the nine months beginning July 2025 have seen net foreign institutional outflows, and March 2026 set a record for FII selling. Between late February and early April, foreign institutional investors were persistent net sellers in the cash equity market. This sustained outflow of foreign capital has not only put pressure on the rupee but also affected sentiment around it.

INTEREST RATE DIFFERENTIALS An interesting trait of capital flows is that they often tend to chase the interest rate differential, adjusted for the perceived country risk parameter, reflecting sentiment about a particular currency. Thus, even with unchanged fundamentals across two countries, if a country is perceived to have become more (less) risky by the not-so-rational market players exhibiting herd behaviour, there may be sharp changes in capital flows and consequent exchange rate movements.

Once sentiment turns, the currency market begins to form expectations that can affect the behaviour of various economic agents. For example, if foreign investors expect, say, a 10 per cent depreciation ahead, then a 12 per cent rupee return on an Indian asset shrinks to a meagre 2 per cent in dollar terms — reason enough to diversify to other markets with higher expected returns. Exporters and remittance senders, anticipating a better exchange rate tomorrow, sit on their dollars today. Importers, fearing the opposite, rush to stock up. Speculators also try to take advantage. Each of these reactions, individually rational, collectively drags the currency down further. A strong

Exchange rates are affected simultaneously by goods and asset markets, each adjusting at different speeds

expectation of depreciation, in other words, can become a self-fulfilling prophecy.

As regards the timing of the intervention by the Indian authorities, RBI Governor’s Monetary Policy Statement of April 8, 2026, stated candidly:

“Despite stronger macroeconomic fundamentals, the Indian rupee in 2025-26 depreciated more than the average in the previous years. In this regard, let me reiterate that our exchange rate policy remains unchanged. Specifically, intervention in the foreign exchange market is aimed at smoothening excessive and disruptive volatility without targeting any specific level or band for the exchange rate. This is consistent with our long-standing policy of the exchange rates being market-determined. The RBI stands committed to this policy and would judiciously contain excessive or disruptive volatility to ensure that self-fulfilling expectations do not exacerbate currency movements beyond what is warranted by fundamentals.”

In practice, finding the fundamental value of the rupee can be quite difficult. Exchange rates are affected simultaneously by goods and asset markets, each adjusting at different speeds. In fact, one of the most celebrated theories of exchange rates (*a la* the American economist Rudiger Dornbusch) argues that currencies routinely overshoot their equilibrium values. In a quarter as turbulent as the Q1 of 2026, pinning down a single “correct” level for the rupee would have been an exercise in false precision.

DOESN’T STIMULATE EXPORTS Depreciation cuts the economy in two ways. A cheaper rupee may help exporters price more attractively abroad, but because Indian exports are import-intensive — think oil, raw materials, intermediate goods, and capital goods — the cost of producing those very exports rises in tandem. Domestic inflation creeps up. The competitiveness gain turns out to be smaller and more fragile than it looks on paper, while the costs to households and firms are immediate and tangible. Moreover, if all EME currencies depreciate *vis-à-vis* the dollar, the

relative competitiveness of currencies remains largely unchanged; therefore, depreciation of the rupee does not help stimulate exports, particularly when it is fully offset by adverse terms of trade from rising production costs.

However, the gradual decline of the rupee may have affected market sentiment and contributed to the FII outflows. The deeper causes of the FII exodus go well beyond rupee jitters. While the overall macro indicators remained strong, slower corporate earnings at home due to lower nominal GDP growth, stretched equity valuations as reflected in higher P/E ratios, the lack of AI-related stocks in India, oil-price anxieties, and the ongoing conflict in West Asia could have pushed global capital towards other destinations. On the other hand, in the US, uncertainty over its tariffs, immigration, and high yield rates has kept dollar assets relatively appealing. Depreciation expectations have amplified an already bearish story — a classic Catch-22 in which outflows trigger depreciation, and depreciation in turn triggers more outflows.

Expectedly, the intervention will curb disorderly swings. With comfortable forex reserves behind it, the RBI has the firepower to do so. It also has the intellectual backing of the IMF’s Integrated Policy Framework, which holds that forex intervention is part of the legitimate toolkit for EMEs to manage exchange rates. A spell of rupee stability lets trade and finance plan ahead, and restores a measure of calm to an economy. Hopefully, peace will endure in West Asia, risk perceptions of oil-importing developing countries will subside, and India’s economy can look forward to a more stable external environment in the near future.

In some sense, the recent rupee swings in an otherwise strong economy with the highest growth among the G-20 economies, reminds one of Luigi Pirandello, the Italian playwright, who in his celebrated play, *Six Characters in Search of an Author*, said, “Life is full of strange absurdities, which, strangely enough, do not even need to appear plausible, since they are true.”

Pal is with IIM Calcutta, Kolkata and Ray is with NIBM, Pune. Views are personal

Millets are still not on our menu

Availability of subsidised rice and wheat and diets diversifying towards dairy, fruits and meat are main reasons

Anjani Kumar
Vanshika Pahwa
Smita Sirohi

India has positioned itself as the global champion of millets. From leading the International Year of Millets in 2023 to promoting “Shree Anna” in national campaigns, policymakers have rightly highlighted millets as nutritious, climate-resilient crops suited for a warming world. India alone accounts for nearly 38 per cent of global millet production, making it central to the future of these crops worldwide.

Yet beneath the celebration lies an uncomfortable reality: Indians are eating fewer millets than ever before. Recent study using nationally representative household consumption surveys shows that millet consumption has fallen dramatically over the last three decades. In rural India, annual per capita millet consumption declined from 25.1 kg in 1987-88 to just 3.4 kg in 2023-24 — a drop of nearly 86 per cent. Urban consumption also fell sharply from 9.6 kg to 2.3 kg during the same period. Millets have not only declined in absolute terms — they have nearly vanished from India’s cereal basket. In rural areas, the share of millets in total cereal consumption fell from 14.2 per cent to 2.3 per cent between 1987-88 and

2023-24. In urban India, the share declined from 7.1 per cent to 1.7 per cent.

WHY HAS THIS HAPPENED? The answer lies not in consumer ignorance alone, but in policy design. For decades, India’s food system has heavily favoured rice and wheat. Public procurement, irrigation investments, fertilizer support, and the Public Distribution System (PDS) made these cereals cheap, reliable, and widely available. When rice and wheat are subsidised at scale, households naturally substitute away from millets. Households’ everyday economics matters. If a family can buy subsidised rice for a fraction of market prices, millet becomes a difficult choice even when it is healthier.

The decline is especially striking among lower-income households, for whom millets were once an important staple. The expansion of subsidised cereal distribution has likely accelerated the replacement of millets in household diets. Economic growth has further reinforced this trend. As incomes rise, diets diversify towards dairy, fruits, fish & meats, and processed foods. Urban consumers also value convenience, branding, and ready-to-cook products — areas where rice and wheat dominate. Millets often require longer preparation time and remain poorly represented in



REALITY. Indians are eating fewer millets than ever before DEEPAK KR

mainstream retail markets. Millets also face weak value chains. Limited processing infrastructure, inconsistent retail availability, and patchy branding have kept them niche products in many cities. Even consumers who want to buy millets often struggle to find affordable, attractive options.

This matters because millets offer genuine advantages. They are rich in iron, calcium, fibre, and other micronutrients. They are drought tolerant, require fewer inputs, and are better suited to rain-fed regions facing climate stress. For dry-land farmers, millets can be both an economic and ecological asset. But reviving millets requires more than symbolic support or annual celebrations.

Even though minimum support prices (MSPs) for millets have risen faster than

for rice and wheat in recent years, cultivation remains less remunerative in many areas because procurement is weak and markets are thin. The signal exists; the ecosystem does not. Farmers will grow millets sustainably only if consumers buy them consistently.

That means shifting policy attention from production alone to demand creation. Millets should be integrated more systematically into school meals, anganwadis, hospitals, and urban nutrition programmes. Private investment in millet snacks, breakfast cereals, bakery products, and ready-to-cook foods should be encouraged. Better branding and modern retail placement can help reposition millets from “coarse cereals” to aspirational healthy foods. Most importantly, cereal policy itself needs rebalancing. If rice and wheat continue to receive overwhelming support, millets will remain marginal despite official enthusiasm.

India has shown the world why millets matter. The next challenge is ensuring they matter again at home. A millet revolution will succeed not when we celebrate millets, but when we eat them.

Anjani and Vanshika are Senior Research Fellow and Research Analyst, respectively, at International Food Policy Research Institute, New Delhi. Smita is National Professor, at ICAR-National Institute of Agricultural Economics and Policy Research, New Delhi

✉ **LETTERS TO EDITOR** Send your letters by email to bleditor@thehindu.co.in or by post to ‘Letters to the Editor’, The Hindu Business Line, Kasturi Buildings, 859-860, Anna Salai, Chennai 600002.

Pros and cons of ethanol This refers to ‘Fuel for thought’ (April 29). Ethanol is a renewable fuel derived primarily from sugarcane and corn. Its use can significantly reduce dependence on fossil fuels and help lower greenhouse gas emissions. But the shift to 100 per cent ethanol vehicles is not without drawbacks. One major concern is the potential strain on agricultural resources, as large-scale ethanol production may compete with food crops, leading to higher food prices. Ethanol also has a lower energy

density compared to petrol, which can result in reduced fuel efficiency and shorter driving ranges. Vehicles would require specific modifications to run entirely on ethanol, which may increase costs for consumers and manufacturers. Careful planning and balanced policies are essential to address their limitations.

Bal Govind
Noida

An FTA of significance The free trade agreement (FTA) signed between India and New

Zealand, aiming to double bilateral trade to over \$5 billion annually, is significant on several counts. By eliminating duties on all Indian exports to New Zealand — valued at \$711 million in 2024-25 — it creates opportunities in labour-intensive sectors such as textiles, jewellery and leather. While New Zealand will gain zero-duty access for around 70 per cent of its exports, including wood, wool and fruits, India has prudently safeguarded sensitive sectors, particularly dairy, along with items such as onions, peas, almonds and

most meat products. A network of well-crafted FTAs with like-minded economies can enhance India’s strategic stability and leverage in an increasingly polarised trade order.

M Jeyaram
Sholavandan, TN

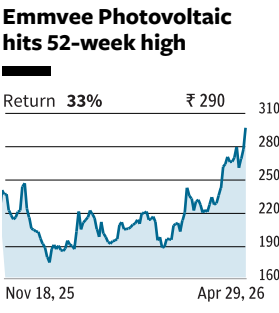
Options market reforms This refers to ‘SEBI weighs uniform regime for options strike prices’ (April 29). The proposal to allow exchanges to add intra-day strike prices, especially at-the-money options during sharp market moves,

is a welcome step towards improving liquidity and efficiency. However, the current system’s lag in introducing new strikes often forces traders to use illiquid far-off contracts or accept wider spreads, increasing costs and risk. A uniform framework across exchanges would reduce inconsistencies and help market participants hedge more effectively. SEBI could consider clear guidelines on the frequency and conditions for adding strikes.

A Myilsami
Coimbatore



QUICKLY.



Mumbai: Shares of Emmvee Photovoltaic Power Ltd surged to a 52-week high of ₹299.50 on Wednesday, as investors reacted to the company's robust Q4 and full-year FY26 results. The stock, however, closed at ₹290.84, up 6.82 per cent over the previous day's close. . The Bengaluru-based solar module and cell manufacturer posted revenue from operations of ₹5,049.9 crore for FY26, more than doubling from ₹2,335.6 crore in FY25 while profit after tax jumped to ₹1,081.6 crore — a 193 per cent year-on-year increase. The company ended the year virtually debt-free, with a net debt-to-equity ratio of negative 0.06x. **OUR BUREAU**

IIFL Finance Q4 net jumps two-fold to ₹623 crore

New Delhi: IIFL Finance reported over two-fold increase in consolidated net profit to ₹623 crore for the fourth quarter ended March 2026, due to a rise in interest income and improved asset quality. It earned a net profit of ₹251 crore in the same quarter a year ago. The consolidated total income during January-March 2026 rose to ₹3,700 crore compared to ₹2,594 crore in the year-ago period. Interest income increased to ₹3,330 crore during the quarter against ₹2,483 crore in the year-ago period. The gross NPAs moderated to 1.46 per cent from 2.2 per cent at the end of March 2025. **PI**

Sensex jumps 609 points as UAE's OPEC exit spurs hopes of softer crude

TOP MOVERS. Among gainers, FMCG, auto and IT stocks in the lead while financials witness selling pressure

Anupama Ghosh
Mumbai

Markets closed higher on Wednesday, with the Sensex gaining 609.45 points or 0.79 per cent to settle at 77,496.36 and the Nifty advancing 181.95 points or 0.76 per cent to end at 24,177.65 — the primary catalyst being news of the UAE's exit from OPEC, which raised hopes of greater oil supply and softer crude prices ahead, a significant positive for an import-dependent economy like India. The session, however, was far from one-directional. Both indices touched intraday highs — Sensex at 77,982 and Nifty at 24,335 — before profit-booking in the latter half trimmed gains. Brent crude remained elevated near

\$114 per barrel, with domestic crude futures surging toward ₹9,800, effectively reversing much of April's earlier correction. The persistence of geopolitical risks around the US-Iran conflict, the unresolved Strait of Hormuz closure, and the ongoing US naval blockade continued to keep energy markets on edge.

GAINERS AND LOSERS Sectorally, FMCG led gains with a near 1.7 per cent advance, followed by Realty at around 1.3 per cent and Auto and IT each posting roughly 1 per cent gains. Heavyweights including ITC, Reliance Industries, Maruti Suzuki, and Tech Mahindra, were among the top contributors. On the other side, Media slipped nearly 0.6 per cent, while PSU



OIL TO FOIL? Brent crude was elevated near \$114 per barrel, with domestic crude futures surging toward ₹9,800, as the UAE move fails to make much of an impact **BLOOMBERG**

Banks, Financials, and Consumer Durables faced mild selling pressure. IndiGo and Dr Reddy's ended as the session's top laggards. In the broader market, the Nifty Midcap 100 slipped marginally by 0.07 per cent

while the Smallcap 100 gained 0.65 per cent. India VIX continued to ease, suggesting some moderation in near-term fear.

EYES ON US FED Looking ahead, all eyes are on

the US Federal Reserve's interest rate decision, due later Wednesday, along with Jerome Powell's press conference — potentially his last before a leadership transition. “Steady rates aren't necessarily negative; they provide policy clarity and allow investors to plan capital allocation with greater confidence. What truly drives volatility is not what markets anticipate, but what surprises them,” said Ashish Singhal, Co-founder, CoinSwitch. Ajit Mishra of Religare Broking added, “Markets will react to the outcome of the US Fed meeting in early trade on Thursday... elevated crude oil prices near the \$110 mark, along with persistent foreign institutional outflows and a weak rupee, continued to cap the upside.”

MOFSL net loss widens to ₹221 cr in March quarter

Our Bureau
Mumbai

Motilal Oswal Financial Services (MOFSL) reported a consolidated net loss of ₹221 crore for the March-ended quarter, widening sharply from ₹65 crore in the year-ago period due to treasury mark-to-market losses. The operating profit has risen by 25 percent to ₹661 crore during the quarter. Revenue surged 125 per cent year-on-year to ₹2,676 crore. However, total expenses rose by 133 per cent to ₹2,886 crore, dragging the firm into losses during the quarter. A significant portion of the spike in both income

and expenditure was driven by the purchase and sale of commodities worth over ₹1,400 crore. For the full financial year ended March, net profit declined over 25 per cent to ₹1,869 crore, compared with ₹2,402 crore in the previous year. This came even as net revenue rose 12 per cent to ₹9,374 crore. Total expenses were at ₹6,951 crore. In a press release, the company said it saw its highest-ever quarterly after-tax profit of ₹661 crore, up 25 per cent year on year, and an annual profit of ₹2,360 crore, up 16 per cent. Growth was led by the Asset and Private Wealth Management (PWM) business.

Citiust InvIT ends 6% higher on Day 1

Press Trust of India
New Delhi

The units of Citiust TransNet Investment Trust, a transport sector-focused infrastructure investment trust (InvIT), settled over 6 per cent higher against the issue price of ₹100 per unit in their debut trade on Wednesday. The unit started trading at ₹104.50, up 4.5 per cent from the issue price on the BSE. During the day, it jumped 7.13 per cent to ₹107.13 and ended at ₹106.19, a gain of 6.19 per cent. On the NSE, the unit listed at ₹104.60 and ended at ₹106.23. Its market valuation stood at ₹6,477.59 crore. The initial public offering of Citiust TransNet Invest-



FIRM FOOTING. Officials of Citiust TransNet Investment Trust, with Ashish Chauhan, MD and CEO, NSE (Middle), at the listing event

ment Trust received 20.43 times subscription on the closing day of bidding on Tuesday last week.

USE OF FUNDS Proceeds from the issue will be used for partial or full acquisition of securities of SRPL Roads Pvt Ltd and certain identified project special purpose vehicles, including Thrissur Expressway Ltd,

Jorabat Shillong Expressway Ltd, Dhola Infra Projects Pvt Ltd and Dibang Infra Projects Pvt Ltd, as well as for general corporate purposes. Citiust TransNet Investment Trust is a transport sector-focused InvIT, established with an objective to acquire, manage and invest in a portfolio of transport infrastructure assets, including roads, in India.

Strong leasing, higher occupancy boost Mindspace REIT's Q4 performance

Our Bureau
Mumbai

Mindspace Business Parks REIT reported a strong quarterly performance for the March quarter (Q4FY26), driven by robust leasing activity and higher occupancies across its portfolio. Revenue from operations rose 31 per cent on year to ₹888 crore, while net operating income (NOI) jumped 37.4 per cent to ₹742 crore. Distributions for the quarter stood at ₹431 crore, up 9.7 per cent from a year earlier, translating into a distribution per unit (DPU) of ₹6.64. Excluding a one-off tax refund in the base quarter, distribution growth was significantly higher at 24.5 per cent. The REIT also reported record leasing momentum, with gross leasing of 3.5 million square feet (msf) during the quarter, taking the full-year tally to 7.1 msf. Committed occupancy improved sequentially by 1.2 percentage points to 95.7 per cent, the highest since listing. Op-



Ramesh Nair, MD & CEO, Mindspace Business Parks REIT

erational metrics remained strong, with re-leasing spreads at 40.3 per cent for the quarter and portfolio in-place rents at ₹80.4 per square foot per month. The company also pre-leased nearly 2 msf during the quarter. For the full year FY26, Mindspace REIT reported NOI growth of 29.2 per cent to ₹2,664 crore, supported by both organic growth and acquisitions. Net asset value rose 9 per cent to ₹527 per unit, while gross asset value increased 16.1 per cent to ₹47,635 crore. The balance sheet remained stable, with loan-to-value at 24.3 per cent and

cost of debt largely flat at 7.41 per cent. On the growth front, the REIT is advancing a 5.4 msf development pipeline and has announced acquisitions worth ₹5,541 crore in Chennai, which will significantly scale its presence in the market and make it the second-largest office asset owner in the city.

OUTLOOK The REIT reported continued confidence in demand for Grade A office assets, particularly from global capability centres (GCCs). Early pre-leasing trends, especially in Hyderabad, suggest strong tenant visibility ahead of project completions. “FY26 was a strong year across every metric. As seen in Hyderabad, large tenants are committing early, and that is the clearest signal of market confidence,” said Ramesh Nair, MD & CEO. “Our Chennai investments have scaled meaningfully, and the timing could not have been better. The business is in very good shape, and we remain focused on execution,” he added.

Nasdaq-listed MakeMyTrip ‘hires banks for India listing by 2027 first quarter’

Bloomberg

MakeMyTrip, an online travel platform listed on the Nasdaq, is considering a listing in India, according to people familiar with the matter. The company has engaged Axis Capital Ltd., Morgan Stanley and JPMorgan Chase as advisers, and plans to add more banks for the proposed share sale, sources said, asking not to be identified as the information is private. MakeMyTrip is targeting the first quarter of 2027 for the listing, the people said. Deliberations are ongoing, and details, including the size and valuation of the offering, could change. Representatives for the banks didn't immediately respond to requests for comment. A representative for the



company said that it is in the process of evaluating a potential listing in India, which could provide an additional avenue to access capital, including from domestic institutional and retail investors, as well as enable it to provide India-listed equity as potential consideration for growth initiatives. India's IPO market has had a subdued start to 2026 after two years of record fundraising. Equity markets have come under pressure from geopolitical tensions, slowing earnings growth and

uneven foreign inflows. Still, several companies are preparing for the IPOs so that they can launch once market conditions stabilise. The company, which was listed on the Nasdaq in 2010, operates online travel brands including MakeMyTrip, Goibibo and redBus. Its shares have declined about 55 per cent over the past year, giving it a market value of around \$4.5 billion.

DUAL LISTING One of MakeMyTrip's peers, Yatra Online, pursued a dual-listing strategy, listing on Nasdaq in 2016 through a reverse merger with a special purpose company before launching an IPO in India in 2023 at roughly double its Nasdaq market capitalisation. It is currently valued at about \$183 million in India and \$68 million on Nasdaq.

BROKER'S CALL.

Ambit Capital

INDIGO (BUY) Target: ₹1,500 CMP: ₹4,345.90 Key investor pushbacks focus on three key aspects for Interglobe Aviation (IndiGo): Can IndiGo replicate domestic success globally? Is owning an aircraft better than leasing? and plausible capital allocation opportunities given ₹51,600 crore cash on B/S. Our views: IndiGo is taking steps to add routes every year; international ASK increased from 23% (FY23) to 32%; (ii) owning aircraft is less expensive vs leasing and is adopted by global carriers; despite high upfront costs, it reduces long-term finance costs. We expect IndiGo to keep a 40:60 owned-leased mix vs its current 20:80. Whilst near-term headwinds persist, leading to about 22/3 per cent cuts in our FY27/28E EPSs, we expect catalysts to play out in 2HFY27 (new CEO, winter schedule clarity, crude/FX normalisation). We maintain a Buy rating given long-term international expansion plans; expect 15/28 per cent revenue/EBITDA CAGR (FY26-29E); 1yr DCF-based TP of ₹5,300 implies 6x 1yr fwd EV/EBITDA and 5x 1-year fwd EV/EBITDAR. Favourable route mix towards Tier2/3 cities and international destinations. Even though near-term headwinds in the sector persist owing to geopolitical issues, rising crude prices, INR depreciation, etc., we expect meaningful catalysts to play out post 2HFY27. We reckon consensus is yet to factor in the full impact of fuel cost inflation and hence expect risk to consensus FY27E. That said, we build in crude at USD82/bbl and USD/INR 93 for FY27-28E, leading to 22/3 per cent cut in FY27/28E EPS

Emkay Global

MARUTI SUZUKI (BUY) Target: ₹16,200 CMP: ₹13,260.20 Maruti Suzuki India Ltd has reported a steady Q4, with revenue up 28 per cent y-o-y led by 12 per cent y-o-y volume growth and ASPs up 4 per cent q-o-q. EBITDAM was down by 60bps QoQ at 11.7 per cent vs 12.4 per cent in Q3-FY26 (adjusted for a one-off ₹590 crore/120 bps labour core impact) due to 70bps gross margin (GM) contraction. PAT missed estimates due to lower-than-expected other income (MTM loss: ₹750 crore). MSIL targets 10 per cent FY27 domestic PV volume growth (vs 5-7 per cent for the industry, per SIAM) aided by strong underlying demand and consumer sentiment despite the West Asia war (reflected in the 190k unit orderbook, 130k of which is from small cars), low channel inventory (12 days, as of FY26-end), and faster ramp up of 2 new plants (250kpa units each) given strong demand (with limited margin impact in the ramp-up phase). Commodity pressure is seen sustaining (80bps EBITM hit in Q4), but multiple mitigation measures are underway; per the management, there is further headroom for improvement in ASPs from Q4FY26, led by higher-end models/rising EV mix. MSIL targets gaining PV market share led by a healthy pipeline (7 new SUVs, multiple EVs by FY30). FY27/28E EPS is unchanged; maintain Buy with TP of ₹16,200 at 28x FY28E core PER. We favour 2W/CV OEMs over PVs, on a similar demand trajectory, albeit with better pricing flexibility, amid commodity pressures.

businessline is not responsible for the recommendations sourced from third party brokerages. Reports may be sent to: **blmarketwatch@gmail.com**

TODAY'S PICK.

Ramakrishna Forgings (₹599.90): BUY

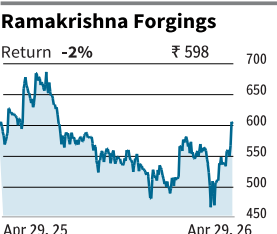
Akhil Nallamuthu
BL Research Bureau

The stock of Ramakrishna Forgings has appreciated 10 per cent so far this week and is up 28 per cent so far in April.

The rally has resulted in the scrip surpassing notable resistance levels at ₹565 and ₹590, which henceforth will act as supports.

In the forthcoming sessions, there is a chance for the price to retest ₹565. But then, the price action shows the trend has turned bullish, so the stock will resume its rally after the minor decline.

We expect the stock to appreciate to ₹720. Therefore, go long at ₹599 and accumulate



at ₹575. Place initial stop-loss at ₹540. When the stock touches ₹650, raise the stop-loss to ₹600. On a rally to ₹700, alter the stop-loss to ₹670. Exit at ₹720.

Note: The recommendations are based on technical analysis. There is a risk of loss in trading.

Day trading guide

24232 » Nifty 50 Futures					
S1	S2	R1	R2	COMMENT	
24200	24000	24450	24600	Buy the contract if it surpasses 24320; stop-loss can be 24200.	

₹779 » HDFC Bank					
S1	S2	R1	R2	COMMENT	
775	760	793	812	Go short if the stock falls below 775; place stop-loss at 795.	

₹1168 » Infosys					
S1	S2	R1	R2	COMMENT	
1150	1120	1180	1215	Buy the stock if it breaks out of 1180; stop-loss can be 1165.	

₹316 » ITC					
S1	S2	R1	R2	COMMENT	
312	308	318	325	Go long if the price moderates to 312; stop-loss can be at 308.	

₹301 » ONGC					
S1	S2	R1	R2	COMMENT	
297	290	305	310	Go long if the price softens to 297; stop-loss can be at 290.	

₹1426 » Reliance Ind.					
S1	S2	R1	R2	COMMENT	
1400	1385	1440	1470	Buy the stock if it softens to 1400; stop-loss can be 1380.	

₹1086 » SBI					
S1	S2	R1	R2	COMMENT	
1080	1070	1115	1150	Buy if the stock rebounds from 1080; stop-loss can be 1060.	

₹2473 » TCS					
S1	S2	R1	R2	COMMENT	
2455	2430	2485	2550	Go long if the stock breaks out to 2485; stop-loss can be 2460.	

S1, S2: Support 1 & 2; R1, R2: Resistance 1 & 2.

Analysts remain bullish on Eternal post Q4, but stock gives up all gains

Madhu Balaji
Bengaluru

Eternal shares closed flat after soaring 5 per cent in early trade on the NSE on Wednesday following its March quarter results, supported by a sharp rise in profitability and continued optimism around its growth businesses. The stock settled flat at ₹254.03, after hitting a high of ₹265.40 compared to the previous close of ₹253.07. The company, which owns Zomato and Blinkit, reported a jump in consolidated net profit to ₹174 crore in the March quarter from ₹39 crore a year ago. Consolidated revenue from operations rose 196 per cent y-o-y to ₹17,292 crore from ₹5,833 crore in the corresponding period last year, reflecting strong traction across segments.

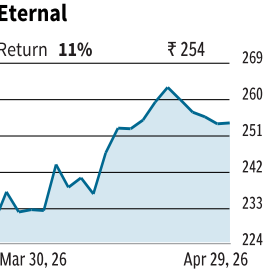
Global brokerage Morgan Stanley maintained an Over-weight rating and marginally raised its target price to ₹347 from ₹345, highlighting that the focus remains on profitable growth.

It said that while near-term market reaction to Q4 may be mixed, underlying metrics remain strong and the quick commerce growth outlook should support estimates.

Investec maintained a Buy rating with a target price of ₹375, stating that visibility on future growth is improving.

However, it flagged potential near-term volatility due to rising competitive intensity, even as execution remains strong.

UBS also maintained a Buy rating with a target price of ₹310. It noted that food delivery growth is gradually approaching the 20 per cent mark, while quick commerce



growth has moderated slightly but continues to see improving profitability despite competition.

CAUTIOUS TONE

In contrast, Macquarie maintained an Underperform rating with a target price of ₹200, citing concerns around moderating sequential growth despite optimistic guidance. It flagged downside risks to throughput improvements and expects dark store expansion to slow.

The brokerage also warned that elevated competitive intensity could pressure unit economics at the micro-market level and cautioned against extrapolating success in select markets across the country.

CLSA maintained a high-conviction Outperform rating with a target price of ₹505, noting that Blinkit's net order value grew 95 per cent y-o-y, broadly in line with estimates, while orders rose over 93 per cent.

Jefferies retained a Buy rating but cut its target price to ₹400, stating that profitability in quick commerce continued to improve despite high competitive intensity.

Motilal Oswal expects gradual margin expansion driven by operating leverage and store maturity, reiterating a buy rating with a target price of ₹340, implying meaningful upside from current levels.

Nifty 50 Movers

	Close(f)	Pts	PE	WN%
Reliance Ind	1425.40	53.78	20.14	8.69
Bharti Airtel	1888.10	29.66	31.05	5.23
ITC	316.25	24.81	19.14	2.75
L&T	4096.10	14.96	29.69	4.34
M&M	3152.30	12.52	23.19	2.54
Infosys	1167.50	11.78	16.06	3.69
Maruti Suzuki	13257.00	10.45	27.91	1.57
Sun Pharma	1778.70	7.25	38.96	1.70
Tech Mahindra	1459.80	7.16	29.76	0.88
TCS	2474.70	6.58	18.51	2.24
Kotak Bank	382.00	6.50	20.21	2.54
Coal India	479.90	6.39	9.52	0.98
Hind Unilever	2314.40	4.82	54.08	1.85
Axis Bank	1296.40	4.63	15.18	3.96
NestleIndia	1465.60	4.00	80.77	0.35
Adani Ports	1661.10	3.78	30.62	1.11
Bajaj Finance	930.00	3.71	31.58	2.24
Eicher Motors	7189.50	3.54	36.81	0.89
TataConsumerProduct	1168.00	2.88	78.55	0.69
Titan	4439.80	2.05	82.70	1.65
Grasim Ind	2803.20	1.68	20.14	0.96
Eternal Ltd	254.03	1.51	106.125	1.65
Tata Steel	215.88	1.50	41.54	1.61
Bharat Elec	437.55	1.41	53.64	1.41
Cipla	1317.60	1.36	23.48	0.67
PowerGrid Corp	320.35	1.33	19.19	1.31
Bajaj Auto	9543.50	1.16	30.02	0.95
Shriram Finance Ltd.	956.85	1.10	17.96	1.21
HDFC Life	594.40	1.00	67.85	0.58
HCL Tech	1200.20	0.97	19.56	1.14
Tata Motors PV	352.70	0.87	47.96	0.67
Adani Enter	2425.90	0.77	19.81	0.57
SBI Life	1816.20	0.77	73.48	0.74
UltraTech Cement	11833.00	0.41	42.58	1.26
Max Healthcare	1006.60	0.30	69.02	0.68
ONGC	301.40	0.08	8.43	1.56
Jio Financial Services Ltd.	250.71	-0.07	102.04	0.74
JSW Steel	1279.70	-0.39	40.30	1.08
Wipro	200.68	-0.56	15.87	0.52
Apollo Hosp	7709.00	-0.99	59.41	0.72
Trent Ltd	4228.30	-1.24	87.32	0.85
Asian Paints	2447.30	-1.51	60.04	1.00
Bajaj Finserv	1764.20	-1.86	14.71	0.92
Hindalco	1067.20	-2.24	14.92	1.39
Dr Reddys Lab	1329.80	-3.30	20.10	0.73
State Bank	1086.90	-3.98	11.59	4.07
InterglobeAvi	4345.20	-4.80	52.32	0.89
WIPAC	401.30	-5.74	15.67	1.72
HDFC Bank	779.00	-4.87	15.14	1.07
ICICI Bank	1281.00	-17.16	15.83	8.26

Pts: Impact on index movement

Nifty Next 50 Movers

	Close(f)	Pts	PE	WN(%)
Vedanta	773.60	164.53	18.26	5.26
Tvs Motor Cmp	3553.90	38.45	55.29	3.34
Dixis Lab	6534.00	36.41	69.97	3.32
Macrotech Developers	912.70	23.69	26.57	1.03
CholamandalamInf	1553.30	20.43	27.30	2.66
Avenueusuper	4593.40	20.37	104.36	2.71
Essence Energy India	3130.10	19.05	99.78	1.17
Zeagoo Group	2769.70	18.53	46.42	0.84
iven Beverages	523.10	17.58	55.12	2.87
Amc	2787.90	15.93	41.79	2.27
Sania Ind	1500.10	15.63	63.03	1.69
rent Pharma	4231.50	14.35	63.03	1.77
	594.45	11.86	33.23	1.53
minis India	5288.00	11.44	65.39	2.86
id Holdings	10305.50	7.21	12.80	1.79
ankstoneronaics	455.10	5.46	32.71	1.30
nterprises	5052.90	5.02	91.14	1.50
Of Bafanda	263.25	2.20	7.06	0.99
(India)	165.66	-0.15	12.66	1.79
nterprises	910.85	-0.32	18.24	0.91
an Railway Finance Corp	105.08	-0.34	139.60	0.85
nan Bank	137.06	-0.38	6.75	1.85
Capital	325.10	-0.85	28.22	0.56
nterprises	111.18	-2.04	21.23	1.75
First Consumer	1090.05	-2.21	61.23	1.75
andia Motor India	1817.30	-3.14	25.50	1.04
nterprises	1389.00	-3.15	61.09	1.72
India	7264.50	-3.48	91.28	1.53
ndus Zinc	613.05	-3.73	18.73	1.06
EnergyGreenery	1244.80	-4.87	103.19	1.67
ubaj Motors Cmp	454.60	-7.23	23.23	1.11
to Motors Cmp	416.95	-7.96	93.24	3.49
ted Spirits	1363.40	-9.17	57.66	1.61
thoofin	3461.10	-10.57	16.06	1.49
Power & Ind Sol	825.60	-10.85	117.19	2.27
Mens	3776.80	-12.60	84.83	1.34
er Cement	1240.00	-12.65	40.49	1.31
an Oilcorp	144.19	-12.66	5.52	1.16
ndirecte	4232.10	-15.06	25.72	1.61
an Energy Solutions	1418.15	-16.94	71.20	1.97
Ion Bank	167.31	-17.29	65.27	1.29
an Hotels Co.	644.65	-19.33	42.39	2.27
nd	303.90	-22.03	5.36	2.47
36345.00	-23.87	3.80	1.26	
wardmotorsinternat	122.24	-24.74	35.74	1.28
dial Steel	1232.10	-39.10	62.14	1.82
ral Elec	393.55	-43.19	5.55	1.82
an Power	216.28	-47.52	37.43	3.63
an Power	451.50	-48.68	28.81	3.03
wer Finance	464.75	-68.44	4.59	2.71

CM
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QUICKLY.

Lift-maker Kone to buy
TK Elevator in \$34-b deal



Helsinki: Finnish lift-maker Kone said it had agreed to buy its German rival TK Elevator in a transaction valued at €29.4 billion (\$34.40 billion). The deal with private equity firms Advent International and Cinven marks one of Europe's biggest takeovers this year. The combination would result in planned synergies estimated to be about €700 million euros on an annual run-rate basis, Kone said. REUTERS

Dr Reddy's gets nod for
Semaglutide in Canada

Hyderabad: Dr. Reddy's Laboratories has received a Notice of Compliance from Health Canada for its generic Semaglutide injection. It becomes the first to receive the market authorisation for generic Semaglutide Injection in Canada, ahead of Health Canada's review target date. The market authorisation covers the 2 mg/pen (1.34 mg/mL) and 4 mg/pen (1.34 mg/mL). OUR BUREAU

Iran-US tensions reroute Indian travellers eastward this summer

Rohan Das
Chennai

The ongoing Iran-US conflict is reshaping Indian summer travel plans, as rising geopolitical uncertainty and disruptions in West Asia push travellers away from West Asia and western destinations toward eastern locations.

Speaking to *businessline*, travel aggregators and other industry executives say that safety concerns alongside higher airfares for flights to the US and Europe have now turned interest towards countries such as Japan, Indonesia, South Korea, Taiwan and Vietnam.

Rikant Pittie, CEO & Co-Founder, EaseMyTrip, said that over the past three-four weeks, there has been a considerable moderation in bookings especially towards traditionally high-demand West Asia corridors. "Demand is getting re-routed rather than cancelled, with destinations like Japan, South Korea, South-East Asia (Thailand, Bali), Maldives and parts of Europe absorbing this shift," he said.

Pavan Kavad, Managing Director, Pritihvi Exchange, a foreign exchange services firm, flagged significant increases in airfares for flights towards Europe and the US.

"A flight from Chennai to New York would cost around ₹80,000 under normal cir-

Messiah or monster? India buckles up for Anthropic's Mythos AI

NO PANACEA. Cybersecurity experts caution the AI model isn't a magic wand against all vulnerabilities

KV Kurmanath
K Ram Kumar
Hyderabad/Mumbai

In a situation reminiscent of a *Spider-Man* movie, where Dr Octavius' fusion reactor makes the audience skip a beat, Anthropic's Claude Mythos is giving sleepless nights to sectors including government, banking, financial services and retail. Is it a breakthrough to celebrate, given its ability to identify and address vulnerabilities automatically, or a Frankenstein's monster that could land in the wrong hands?

While IT major Cognizant sees a huge opportunity in Mythos, others have called for a cautious approach. Claude Mythos AI is a model that can discover vulnerabilities at scale and speed that the world has not seen so far.

A senior executive at a private sector bank envisaged a "digital robbery" scenario with Claude Mythos AI, in which a bank may not even understand how a cyber-attack is unfolding, while cyber attackers already know how to bypass defences.

S Krishnan, Secretary,



WAKE-UP CALL. Organisations across sectors have woken up to the reality of Claude Mythos AI

Ministry of Electronics and Information Technology, said that the government was talking to Anthropic about the concerns over Mythos, terming it a real threat. While banks and financial services companies have stepped up their vigilance, cyber-security companies have cautioned that Mythos is no magic wand, noting that AI can't solve the multi-layered, nuanced networks within an organisation.

"The concerns have led to a lot of discussions within the government, which is speaking to Anthropic. Meanwhile, the CERT-In (Computer Emergency Response Team India) has put out a set of guidelines and an advisory on how this particular issue

needs to be handled," he said.

The government recently set up a committee under State Bank of India Chairman CS Setty to assess the risks posed by Mythos and suggest steps to counter the threat.

Ravi Kumar, CEO of Cognizant, recently said that the goal with leveraging Mythos must not be just discovering vulnerabilities at machine speed, but reinforcing it with remediation and refactoring at the same machine speed. "We see this as a huge opportunity," he said.

Organisations across sectors, government agencies, regulators and cybersecurity companies themselves have woken up to the reality and begun to brainstorm the pros and cons of the new tool, as

Edtech firms pivot to AI-first learning, tweak coding courses

Jyoti Banthia
Bengaluru

India's upskilling platforms are sharply redesigning their programmes, cutting down time spent on coding fundamentals and embedding AI tools into the core learning journey, as generative AI reshapes both job roles and hiring expectations.

The shift is being driven by rapid improvements in AI models that can now handle tasks that previously required months of training, pushing edtech firms to prioritise applied skills, system design and real-world deployment over syntax-heavy learning.

SHIFTING FOCUS

"At a structural level, what used to take six weeks of coding fundamentals can now be done in two weeks with AI-assisted coding," said Arjun Nair, co-founder and COO at Great Learning. "We have reallocated that time toward higher-order skills such as problem framing, data quality, business context and outcome interpretation."

The company has also introduced no-code pathways across programmes, significantly widening its addressable market. "In some programmes, as many as 80 per cent of learners opt for the no-code track," Nair said, adding that learners from non-technical backgrounds

well as ways to address the challenge. Banks have asked the vendors who set up the core banking solution (CBS) platform for them to conduct vulnerability stress-testing and address potential breaches, said a senior executive with a public sector bank. (CBS automates banking processes by networking branches to provide real-time services.)

STRESS-TESTING

The Indian Financial Network (INFINET), the communication backbone of the Indian banking and financial sector, will also be stress-tested for susceptibility to cyber-security breaches. Payment system applications such as Real Time Gross Settlement (RTGS), National Electronic Funds Transfer (NEFT) and RBI's e-Kuber run on this network.

"Mythos can identify vulnerability in an organisation's IT systems, which humans could not detect even after so many years. It can also read all source code and executable files, and zero in on vulnerabilities and how they can be exploited," a banking executive said.

Terming Mythos a meaningful step forward, Ashish Tandon, Founder and CEO of Indusface, said that it is no *panacea*. Asked why we can't use Mythos to create networks without vulnerabilities, he said that a scanner finds bugs in code, but most vulnerabilities do not live there. "They live in how systems are stitched together, in dependencies you do not own, in legacy stacks no one wants to touch, and in the gap between when something is found and when it gets fixed. No tool closes all of that," he pointed out.

"Modern applications are built on hundreds of open-source libraries and third-party components. A vulnerability up the chain becomes your vulnerability, and you do not control the patch cycle," he explained.

Jaspreet Bindra, Co-founder and CEO, AI & Beyond, said, "The real risk is not hypothetical superintelligence, but the rapid deployment of AI into systems that are not yet ready for it."

With inputs from S Ronendra Singh in New Delhi, Rohan Das in Chennai and Sanjana B in Bengaluru

DP World scales up inland transport to aid India-UAE trade

Aneesh Phadnis
Mumbai



Feeder services to alternate ports and multi-modal connectivity is supporting trade between India and the UAE but high freight rates remain a concern for exporters.

DP World, which operates the largest port in West Asia at Jebel Ali, has said inland flows have been scaled up to 1,500 trucks per day carrying bonded cargo from Khor Fakkan and Fujairah ports in the UAE. Shipping lines are operating services to ports like Khor Fakkan, Fujairah, Sohar and Salalah, as the Strait of Hormuz remains blocked. From these ports, goods are being carried inland on trucks to their respective destinations.

PRIORITY-BASED

"Our co-ordinated response across connected gateways is enabling cargo to move through multi-modal corridors and maintaining the flow of goods to Jebel Ali, which remains the main UAE hub for customs clearance and distribution," said Ahmad Yousef Al-Hassan, CEO and Managing Director, DP World GCC.

Al-Hassan said DP World has prioritised transport of food, pharmaceuticals and other critical items. Additional cold chain infrastructure including a reefer pit stop for maintaining desired temperature of refrigerated units have been deployed. Coordination with customs and other regional authorities is ensuring resilience of supply chains, he added.

The UAE is India's largest trading partner in the West Asia region with an annual volume of around \$100 billion in FY25. Trade and investments between the two

countries have surged following the signing of Comprehensive Economic Partnership Agreement in 2022.

ERRATIC SHIPPING

While alternate supply routes have been charted, exporters are complaining of high freight rates and erratic shipping services. Earlier this month, Commerce Minister Piyush Goyal held discussion with the UAE's Minister for Foreign Trade Thani bin Ahmed Al Zeyoudi and stressed the need for co-ordinated efforts for smooth trade operations.

"We have made a representation to the government about the challenges. Shipping Corporation of India is considering feeder services to Khor Fakkan and that could help in lowering freight rates for our exporters," said Ajay Sahai, CEO of Federation of Indian Export Organisations.

Maersk, the world's second-largest container line, said it has adjusted by introducing alternate gateway ports like Khor Fakkan, Salalah, Sohar, Jeddah and Aqaba. "This has ensured continuity of business for reefers and essential commodities. Leveraging on our intermodal capabilities, we have also ensured connectivity into Jebel Ali via Khor Fakkan," said Bhavik Mota, Maersk's Director (Regional Ocean Management - Indian sub-continent, West Asia and Africa).

Air passenger traffic slips marginally in March

Rohit Vaid
New Delhi

India's domestic air passenger traffic slipped marginally in March 2026, as airlines adopted calibrated capacity deployment and raised fares amid elevated Aviation Turbine Fuel (ATF) prices.

According to data released by the DGCA, scheduled domestic airlines carried around 1.44 crore passengers during March 2026, compared with nearly 1.45 crore passengers in March 2025.

On a sequential basis, passenger traffic increased from around 1.43 crore passengers in February 2026.

"Passengers carried by domestic airlines during January-March 2026 were 437.31 lakh as against 431.98 lakh during the corresponding

period of the previous year, thereby registering an annual growth of 1.23 per cent," the DGCA said in its monthly passenger traffic report.

CAUTIOUS APPROACH

Industry observers said airlines adopted a cautious approach to capacity deployment during the month amid elevated fuel prices and geopolitical uncertainty.

Consequently, higher ATF costs prompted several carriers to rationalise capacity across select routes, while introducing fuel surcharges to offset rising operating expenditure.

Besides, the data showed that passenger load factor softened across most airlines in March compared with February, suggesting weaker seat utilisation despite stable traffic.

Navi Mumbai airport says VIP lounges part of tariffs

Our Bureau
Mumbai

Navi Mumbai International Airport (NMIA) has said VIP lounges are a common feature across airports and any suggestion to exclude them from tariff determination disregards contractual obligation and regulatory precedent.

The airport has said this in response to International Air Transport Association's (IATA) objections for a ₹55-crore VVIP terminal.

IATA CONTENTION

IATA contends that costs associated with a VVIP terminal should not be recovered from ordinary passengers, as the facility will not generate any revenue.

Requiring airlines and passengers to fund sovereign protocol infrastructure would be fundamentally inconsistent with the principles of user-pay and and



cost-relatedness, IATA had said in its submissions to the Airport Economic Regulatory Authority.

In its counter reply, NMIA said, "The form, scale and configuration of such facilities are to be determined based on operational, security and regulatory considerations in consultation with the concerned authorities. The nomenclature used—whether "VIP lounge" or "VVIP / protocol facility"—does not alter the functional requirement or the underlying obligation to provide appropriate infrastructure for protocol movement."

Women in boardrooms top 10 lakh, still less than half the men number

Remain significantly under-represented in key decision-making institutions, says a report by Statistics Ministry

Shishir Sinha
New Delhi

The number of women in India's corporate boardrooms crossed 10 lakh at the end of 2025, still lower than half of the number of men in such positions, a report by Statistics Ministry, released on Wednesday, showed. Meanwhile, the share of women among judges, police and army are not very encouraging either!

The 27th edition of the annual publication, *Women and Men in India*, by the Statistics Ministry termed decision-making as fundamental to the exercise of agency and the ability of individuals to shape social, economic and political outcomes. Women, who are equally affected by contemporary challenges in development, peace and security must, therefore, be engaged

in decision-making processes across all spheres and at all levels, it said.

Yet, "despite this imperative, women remain significantly under-represented in key decision-making institutions, particularly within legislative, judicial and executive domains," it said. Moreover, available data on women's participation in public decision-making often fails to fully capture women's autonomy and agency in private and community spaces, where entrenched social norms and discriminatory practices continue to constrain their ability to make choices freely, it added.

CORPORATE BOARDS

Talking about women participation in the corporate world, the report highlighted that there was around 74 per cent increase



The great gender divide

Year	Board of directors		Senior management position		Other management position	
As on Dec 31	Male	Female	Male	Female	Male	Female
2021	17.2	6.3	1.7	0.30	16.1	6.1
2022	18.6	7.0	1.8	0.33	17.5	6.8
2023	19.7	7.6	1.9	0.35	18.6	7.4
2024	22.2	8.9	1.9	0.38	21.1	8.7
2025	24.5	10.0	2.0	0.42	23.3	9.8

Source: Women and Men in India 2025, MCA

in men engaged in managerial positions between 2017 and 2025, whereas there has been over 102 per cent increase in women engaged in managerial posi-

tions during the same period. Data showed that while the number of men in boards reached over 24 lakh as on December 31, 2025, that of women was little

over 10 lakh. The report also recorded the presence of 287 transgenders in the boards.

In judiciary, the report highlighted that of the 1,122 approved judicial positions, only 118 are held by women, accounting for just 14.3 per cent of the judiciary. In the Supreme Court, women constitute merely 3.03 per cent of the permanent strength of 33 judges. Among the States and Union Territories (UTs), Sikkim has the highest share of women among judges with 33 per cent, followed by Punjab & Haryana with around 29 per cent and Telangana with 25 per cent.

DEFENCE SECTOR

In the defence sector, including the army and navy, the number of women serving has increased between 2020 and 2025.

Women account for 8.31 per cent of the total armed forces with the highest share in the Defence Research and Development Organisation (15.42 per cent), followed by Indian Air Force (12.92 per cent). Among the police officers, women constitute 10 per cent of the total strength.

Meanwhile, the report said that women's participation in household decision-making has seen a marked improvement, as at least 16 out of 28 States and six out of eight UTs report more than 90 per cent of women participating in household decision-making as of 2019-21.

It also mentioned that the sex ratio at birth has increased at the all-India level, indicating improved survival of females reaching from 904 in 2017-19 to 917 in 2021-23.

average of trade price(s) for the last half an hour; 52-Week High/Low figures other than ₹10 is indicated in brackets immediately following the name of the (ed) is denoted in thousands.
multiply of each stock is based on the latest declared earnings.
takes into account the per share earnings of each company for the latest 12

of Cons.	4674.90	4799.15		
Sera Eng [2]	2576.55	2555.00		
phire Fds [2]	174.80	209.05		
C Fin	94.52	94.12		